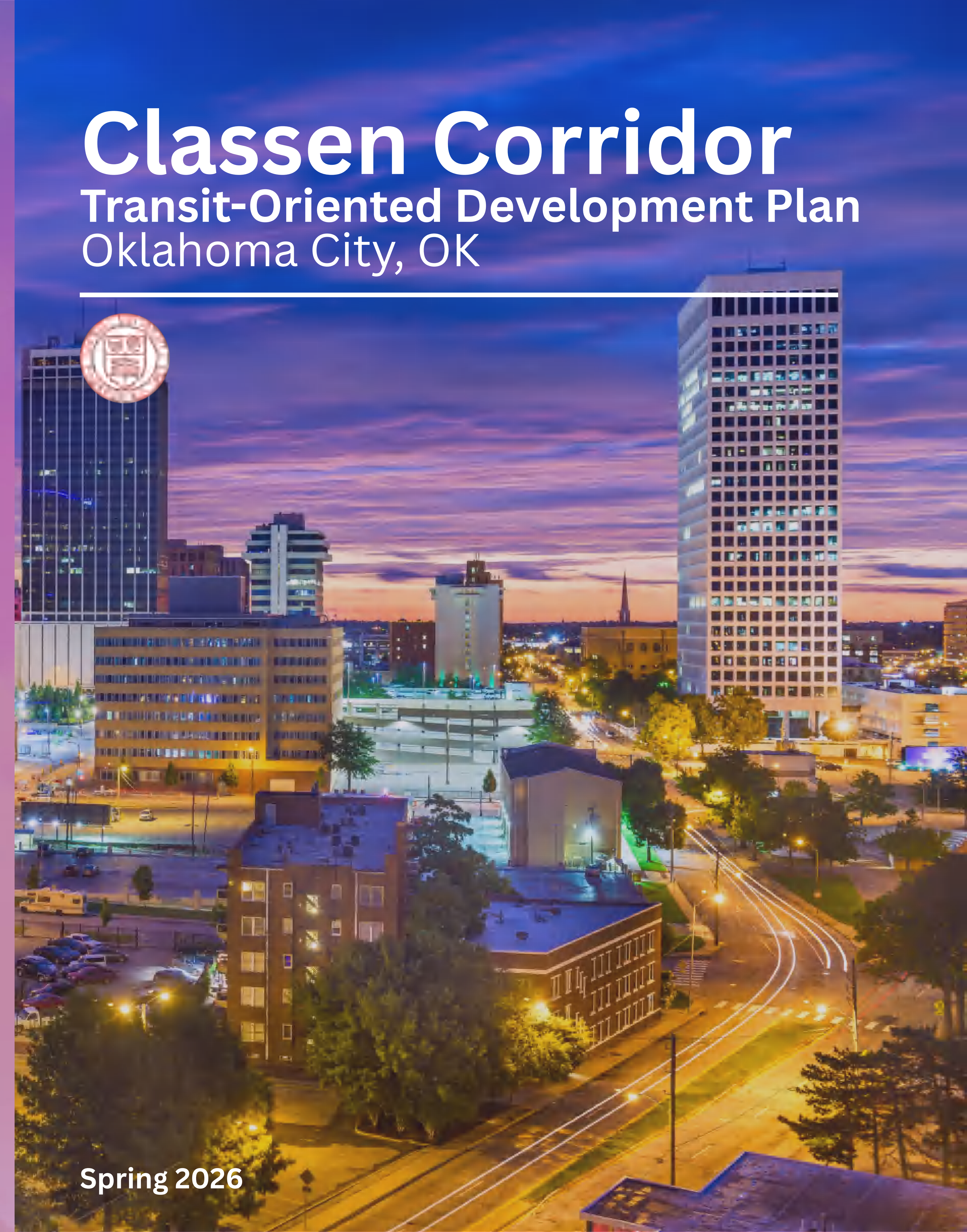
Classen Corridor

Transit-Oriented Development Plan

Oklahoma City, OK



Spring 2026

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INTRODUCTION

This document was created to picture the future of Classen Boulevard in Oklahoma City following the city's acceptance of a $975,000 federal grant to advance Transit-Oriented Development. This document is a ‘Small Area Plan’ that takes inventory of the existing conditions of the site, and then outlines several proposed methods of improvement. Drawing inspiration from similar TOD small area plans across the United States, this plan aims to offer a cohesive, evidence-based vision for the corridor's future.

PLAN INTENT

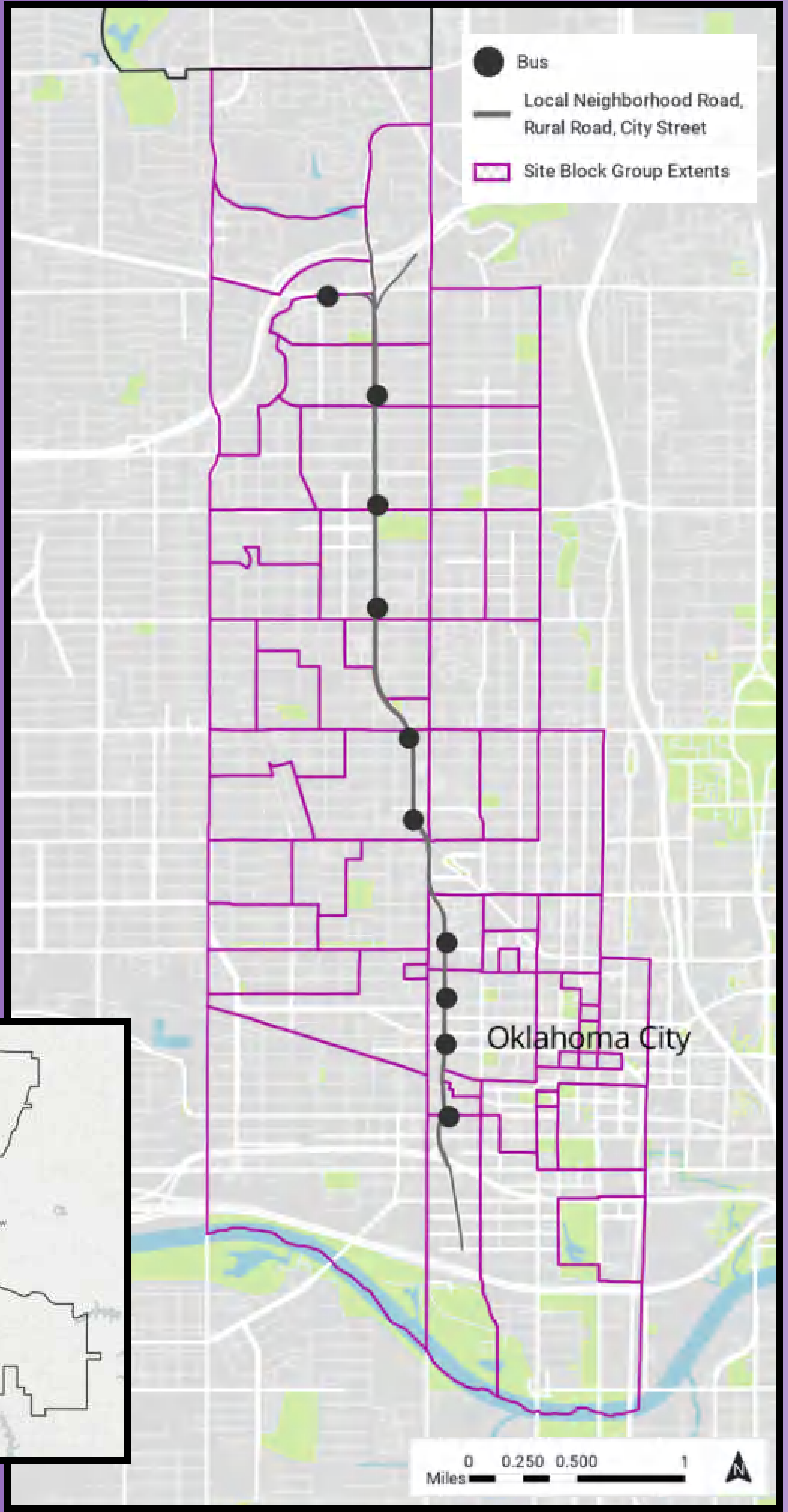
The Classen Corridor Transit-Oriented Small Area Plan sets a vision for the Classen Boulevard corridor and its surrounding land uses. Researched, designed, and curated by a team of Cornell University Master of Regional Planning students, this document intends to:

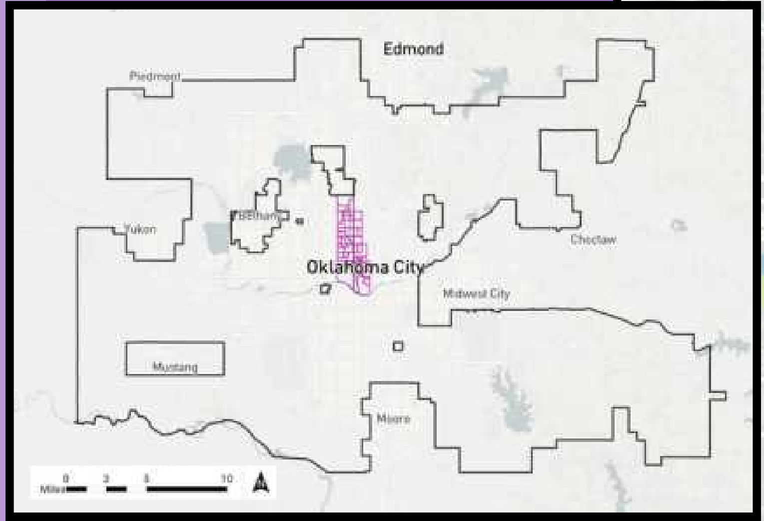
- Provide guidance on how best to utilize the $975,000 grant awarded by the Federal Highway Administration
- Generate new and innovative approaches to land use planning along Classen Boulevard
- Guide the future actions of Oklahoma City officials and community stakeholders toward a more equitable, transit-oriented corridor

STUDY AREA

This map shows the location of our site relative to the boundaries of Oklahoma City. The dark gray line represents Classen Boulevard, while the lighter purple lines denote the adjacent block groups examined throughout this section. The large dots on the map signify the 11 most prominent bus stops in our small area.

Oklahoma City has a uniquely irregular geography, shaped in part by its historical methods of land acquisition and allocation. Often compared to an octopus, the city sprawls outward in every direction from its core. However, if Oklahoma City is an octopus, then Classen Boulevard is its spine, running through the heart of the city and connecting a major shopping mall in the north to the density and diversity of downtown to the south.



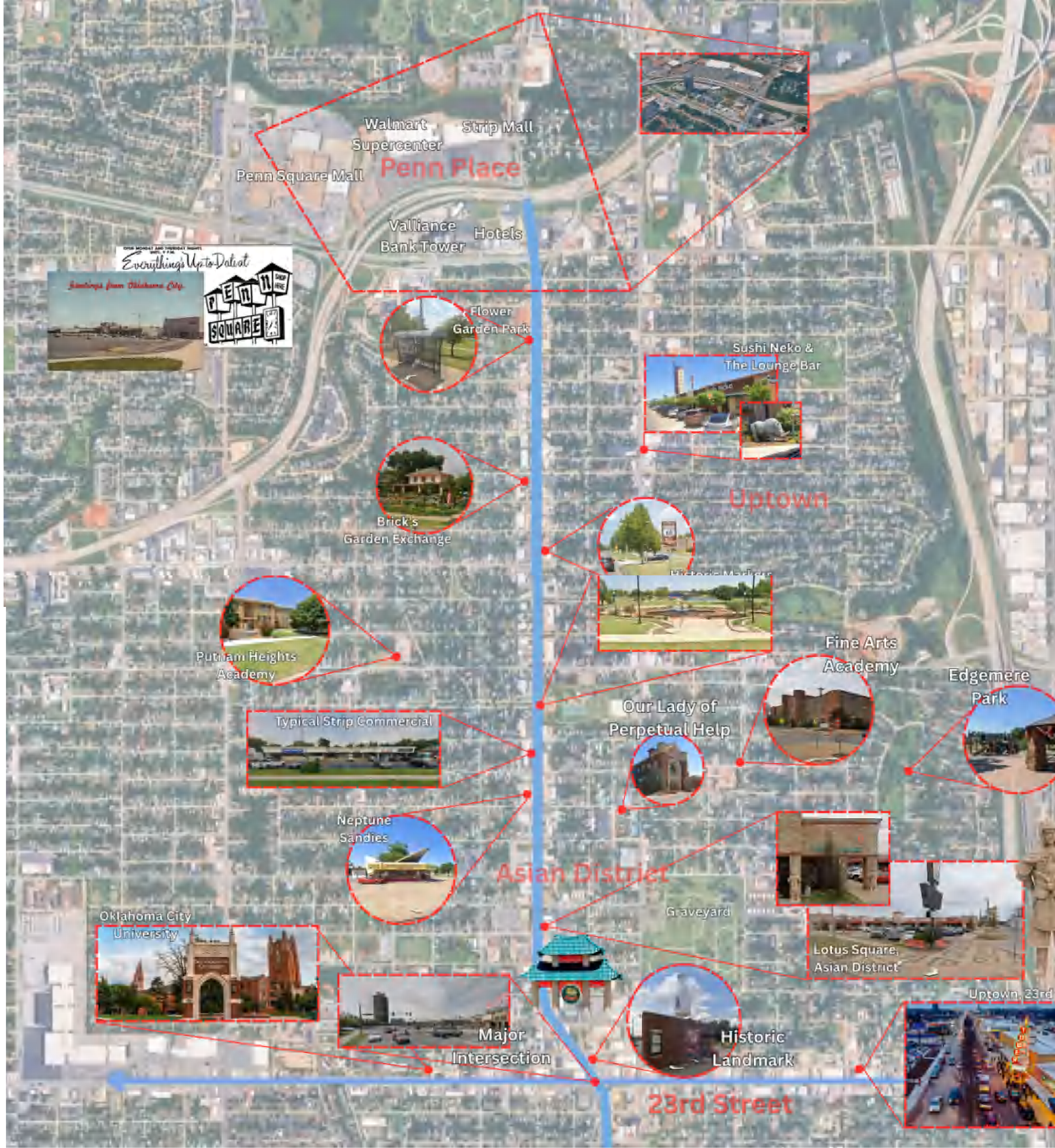


SITE INVENTORY

This map is featured so that you can orient yourself with the site and its significant features. Classen Boulevard is an important transit way in Oklahoma City that connects several significant neighborhoods, including the Penn Place area, Uptown, the Asian District, Midtown, the Plaza District, and Downtown OKC. The corridor is home to primarily one-story commercial sites but also hosts many diverse forms of development and is adjacent to Penn Square Mall, Oklahoma City University, St. Anthony's Hospital, and more. This mix offers a great opportunity to preserve and emphasize the unique and significant cultural landmarks of the community while offering improvements to the existing commercial landscape by increasing the development density to promote additional opportunities for business and housing.

POINTS OF INTEREST

- Penn Square Mall, the largest shopping center in Oklahoma, attracting year long interest.
- Oklahoma City University, one of top universities in the state.
- The Asian District, a distinct hub of commerce and culture in the heart of Classen Boulevard.
- Uptown 23rd St, a vibrant old style downtown street and one of the primary east/west boulevards in OKC, meeting our site in the center of the Asian District.



"I like to call the ethos I grew up with 'Oklahoma values.' But you'd be just as accurate if you said 'American values.' Except for our lack of a seacoast, Oklahoma has a little bit of just about everything that's American."

-J. C. Watts

POINTS OF INTEREST

- The Plaza District, a newly emerging scene filled with street art, unique eateries, and local wears.
- SSM St. Anthony is a premier hospital, and a staple of the OKC community and the wider region for its excellent service.
- Automobile Alley, a historic neighborhood bordering the heart of OKC known for its retro flare and assortment of hidden gems such as Factory Obscura: Mixtape.
- Downtown OKC is the true heart of the city, featuring the iconic Devon Tower, Scissortail Park, the Myraid Botanical Gardens, and the newly constructed Paycom Center, home of the award winning OKC Thunder.

PROJECT HISTORY

1897:

Classen Boulevard is named after Anton Classen, who was a prominent civic leader and land developer who arrived in Oklahoma City in 1897. He purchased farmland on the outskirts of the city, not necessarily to farm, but to hold onto and use as an investment and collateral. Ultimately, he built numerous housing additions and worked to connect his residential developments to the inner core of Oklahoma City.

1902:

Classen co-founded the Metropolitan Railway Company and established a streetcar that ran along Classen Boulevard. This new transit system connected the corridor to the economic development of downtown Oklahoma City. This newfound transit system made Classen Boulevard the inevitable spine for commercial and residential growth that extended northward. The streetcar network was dismantled over the mid-20th century in favor of the automobile.

2015:

The University of Oklahoma's Institute for Quality Communities partnered with the Urban Land Institute of Oklahoma and the City of Oklahoma City to propose redevelopment options for Classen Boulevard. Their redevelopment plans specifically focused on the area between Reno Avenue and NW 23rd Street. This comprehensive, decade-old study produced both short-term and long-term concepts intended to raise ideas and future discussion points on the corridor.

MARCH 2024:

The City of Oklahoma City Council approved a new Tax Increment Finance District in the area that includes Classen Boulevard from NW 6th Street to NW 36th Street. This new TIF District enables a portion of the local property taxes to be used for private incentives, public infrastructure investments, and affordable housing.

NOVEMBER 2024:

Oklahoma City received a $975,000 federal grant from the U.S. Department of Transportation to plan transit-oriented development along Classen Boulevard. This grant, given to only 10 projects, encourages transit-friendly development, affordable housing, and improved pedestrian and bike access along the RAPID NW bus line. Our small-area plan is an investigation and analysis of how Oklahoma City can best utilize this additional funding.

CORRIDOR VISION

The revitalized Classen Boulevard will become a mixed-use, transit-oriented corridor, acting as a connecting seam in Oklahoma City. It will work to connect all residents to economic and commercial opportunities, along with more densely packed housing. New investment will be designed to complement existing land uses, working to foster a greater sense of community between long-time residents and those newly arriving.

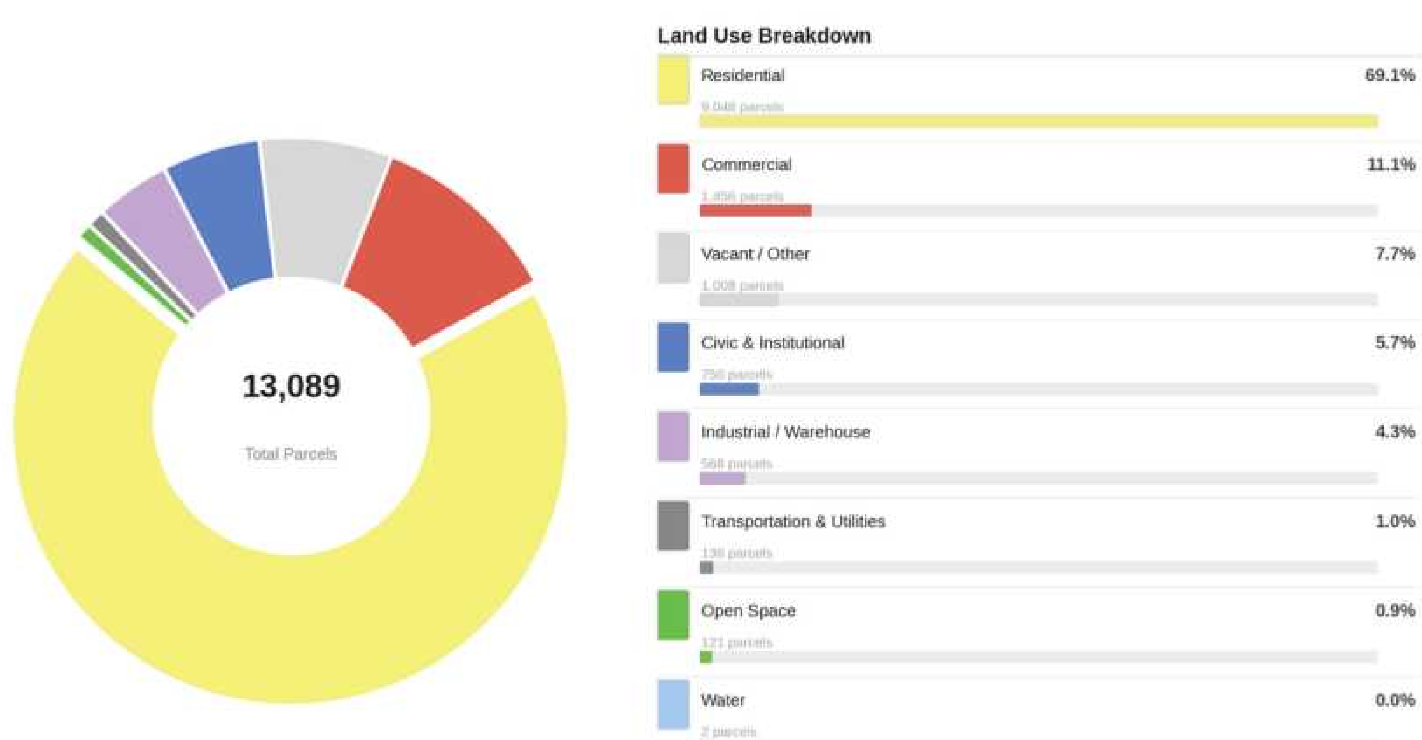
GOALS

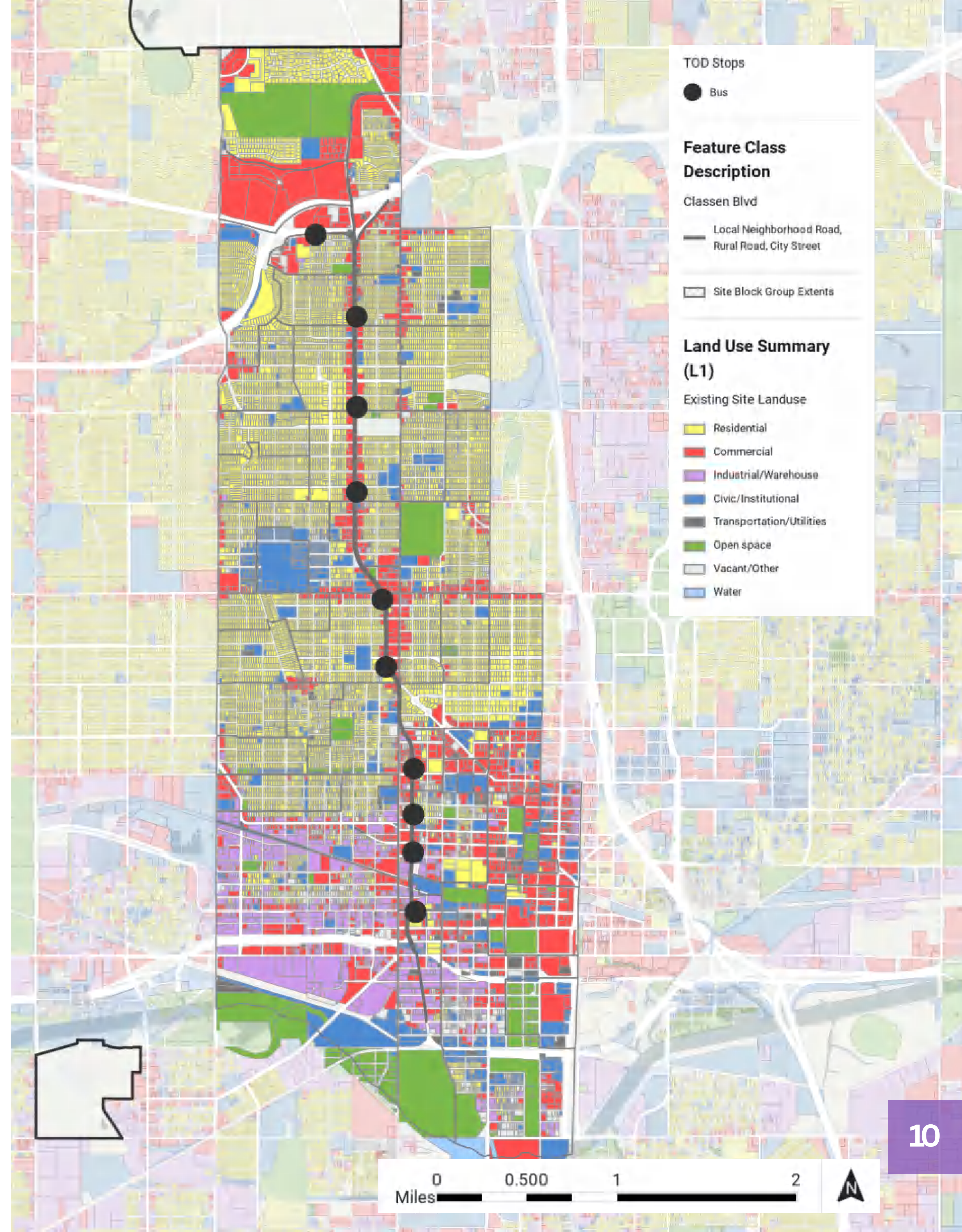
- *Revitalize Classen Boulevard as a people-first, mixed-use transit corridor that connects northwest Oklahoma City residents to all opportunities.*
- *Preserve the cultural identity of the Asian District and surrounding neighborhoods along the corridor.*
- *Ensure that low-income residents are able to benefit from investment along the corridor. Avoid displacement and promote affordable housing.*
- *Encourage zoning reforms that minimize the number of different zoning ordinances and promote those that support improved transit.*
- *Advocate for increased investment using the TIF District funding to build more walkable and bikeable infrastructure along the boulevard.*

LAND USE

The southern end of the Boulevard enters OKC's downtown area, where the density increases and there are many more commercial and industrial uses. The blue areas (5.7% of the area's total land use) represent civic uses, including schools, municipal facilities, and community centers. Shockingly, there is quite a large amount of vacant properties within a close radius to the Classen Corridor (7.7%). While this isn't necessarily the greatest use of land in Oklahoma City, it proves that there is much potential for development that could occur to support the Classen Boulevard TOD plan. By examining the ways in which land is used around our site today, we can start to envision a more economically developed corridor and a more vibrant future for Oklahoma City.

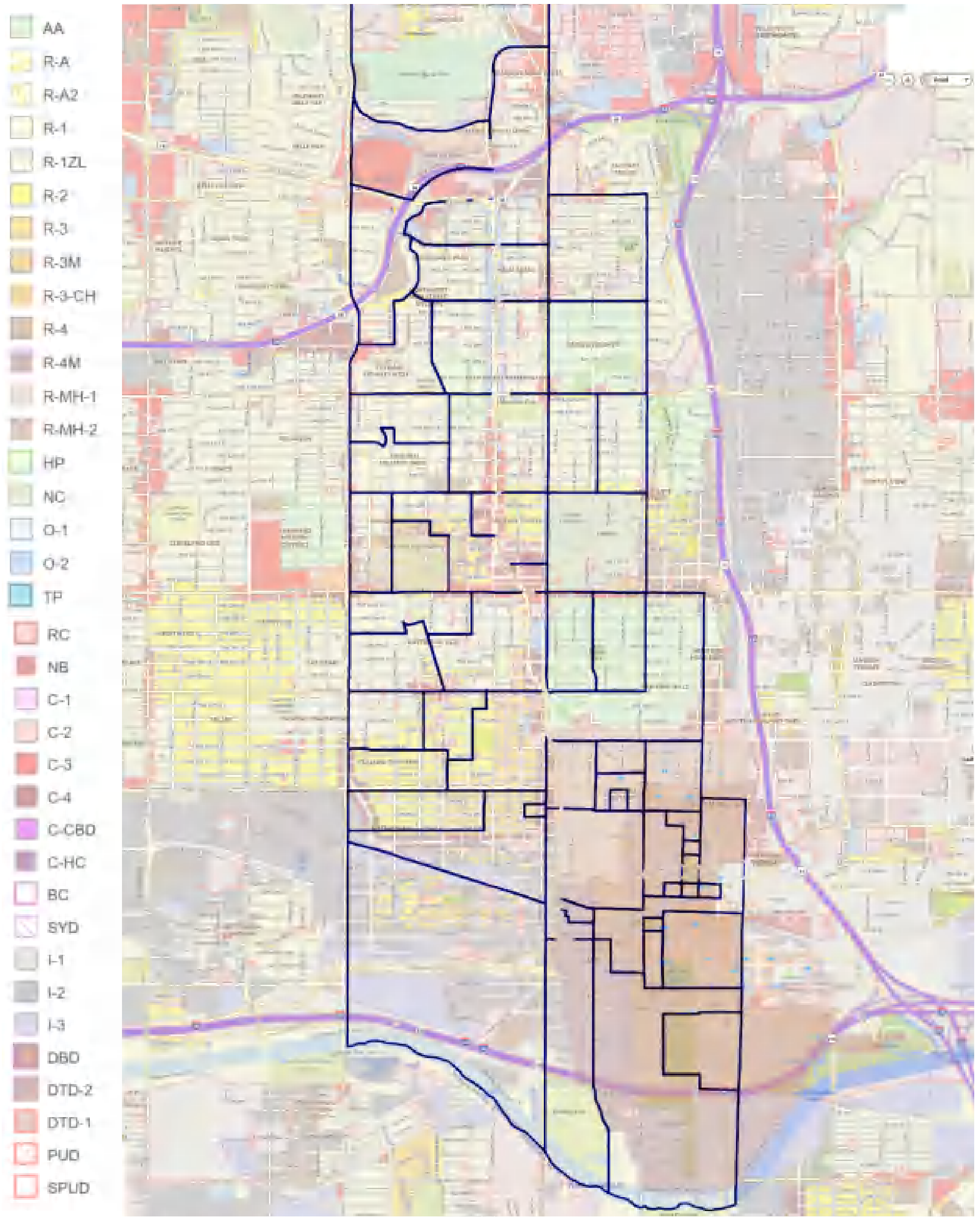
Existing Land Use Distribution — TOD Site (L1)





EXISTING ZONING

This detailed map depicts the current zoning ordinances outlined by the city for the entire site area. The primary zones are R-1, single-family residential, with a relatively small mix of higher-density R-2 and R-3. C-3, community commercial, and HP, Historic Preservation, are also prevalent throughout the site. These uses are generally low-density with high parking requirements.



ZONING OVERLAYS

CLASSEN BOULEVARD

The Classen Boulevard Overlay District is intended to conserve and guide orderly development along the Classen Corridor. However, in its current state, the planned zoning overlay seems to limit what can be built and constrain the growth potential of the future TOD in the area.

UPTOWN CORRIDOR

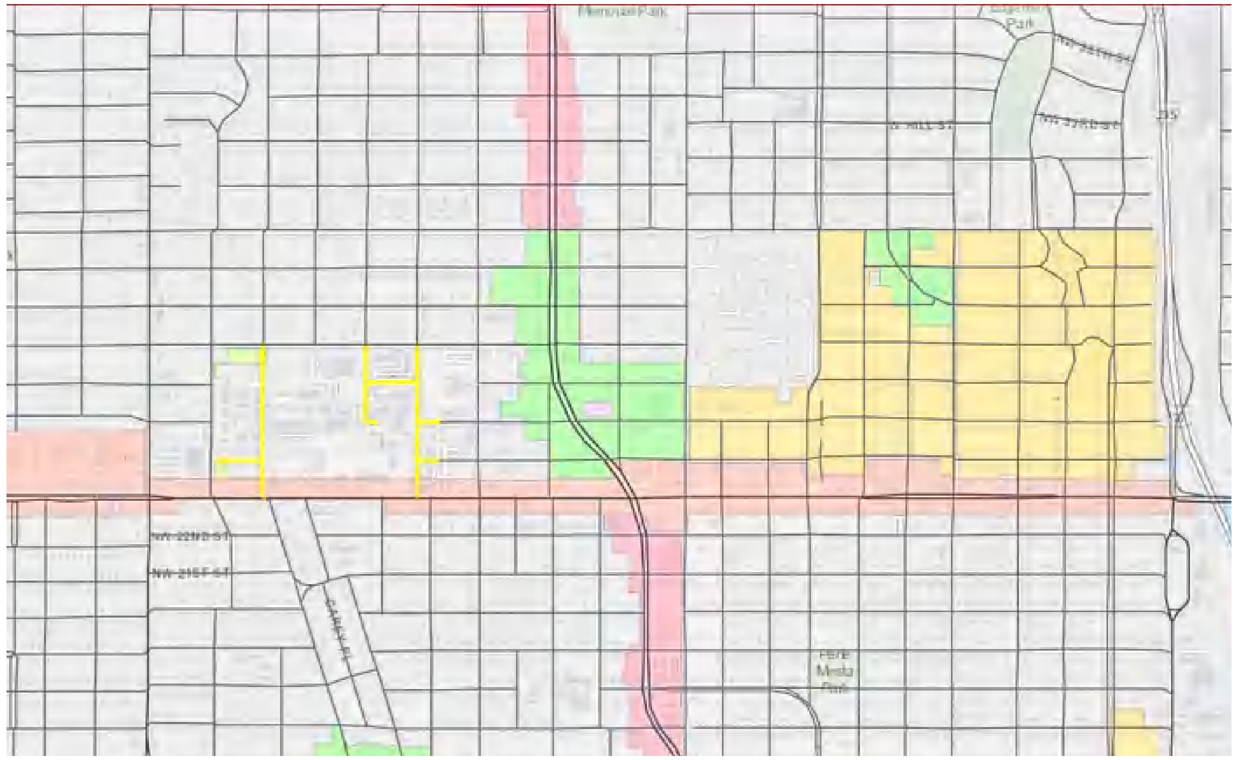
The Uptown Corridor Overlay District encourages development perpendicular to Classen and promotes commercial development to stabilize the surrounding neighborhood residential areas. More intensive commercial uses are discouraged along this horizontal corridor.

URBAN DESIGN

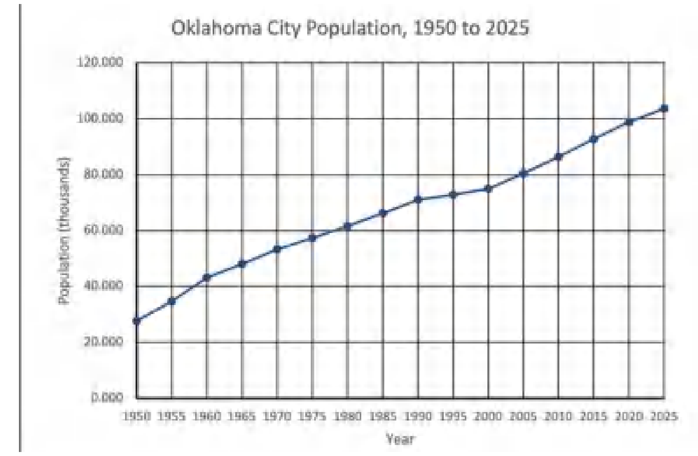
The Urban Design Overlay District is intended to promote the "general welfare of the public" by encouraging the revitalization of the built environment. However, it coincidentally overlaps with the Asian District, so this overlay operates implicitly as a way to maintain the Asian architecture of the area.

HISTORIC LANDMARK

The Historic Landmark Overlay is meant to align with the regulation of any underlying Historic Preservation Zoning Ordinance and is therefore ambiguous. It is applied to agricultural, residential, commercial, or industrial land and applies to a specific parcel or area.

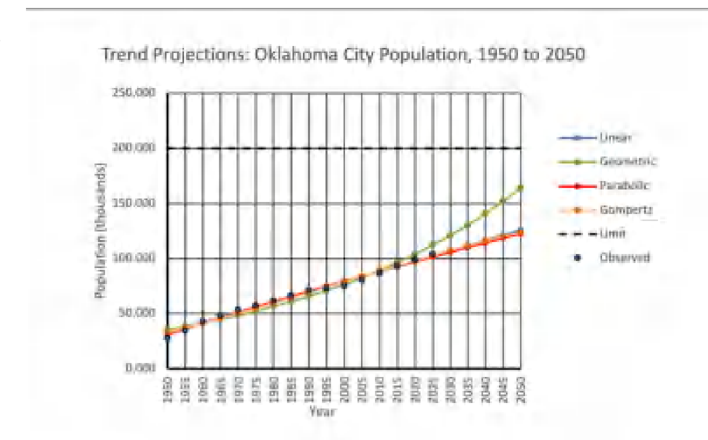


POPULATION GROWTH



Oklahoma City is part of one of the fastest-growing metro areas in the nation. This high rate of growth has been marked since 2000 and has fueled the city's growth in the past several decades.

Oklahoma City's population is expected to continue increasing into the future, creating an increased need for services and increased opportunities for developments such as a rapid transit corridor.



Projection Method	Linear	Geometric	Parabolic	Gompertz
Population (thousands)	1,256,160	1,639,830	1,225,700	1,238,170

These are some of the many ways that demographers chart future populations. These numbers represent some potential scenarios for how the population will increase by the year 2050, with most projections reaching a similar figure of around 1,230,000, with a high estimate of 1,639,830.

DEMOGRAPHICS

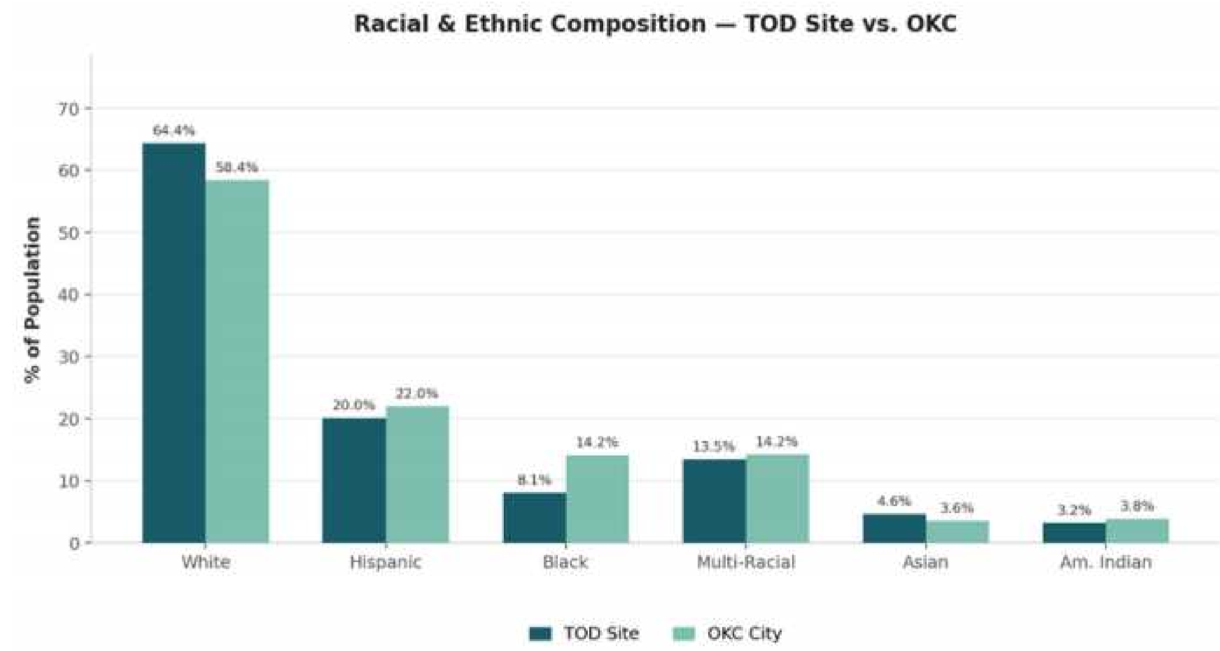
Demographics are data that are used to get a better understanding of a certain population and their characteristics. By studying this data, we can understand the potential needs of the site's residents and ensure that our solutions meet those needs.

Who lives along the corridor?

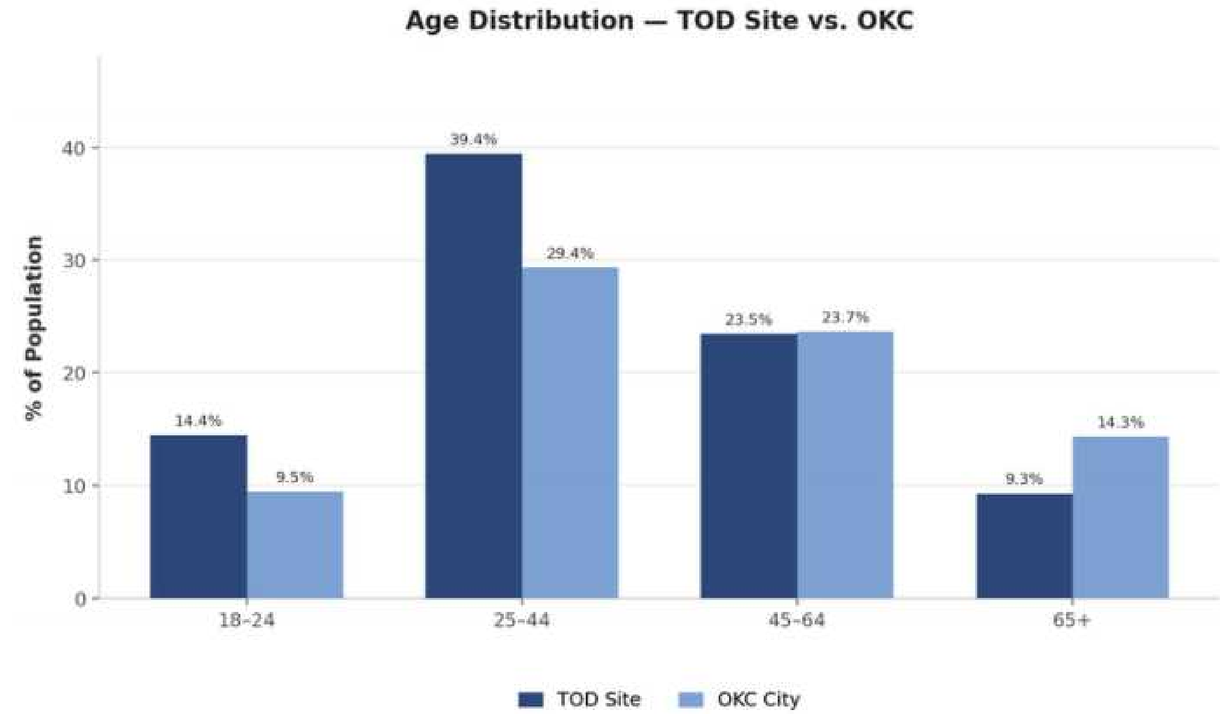
- 3,768 households predominantly made up of working-age adults, with an exceptionally low senior population (only **7%** over the age of 64).
- highly diverse demographic (**13% Hispanic**, 12% Black), highlighted by an Asian population that sits at nearly 3 times the state average.
- A severe combination of a 40% low-income rate, an **18% poverty rate**, and a massive 65% renter population makes this community extremely susceptible to displacement.

What does this look like surrounding our corridor?

- A highly diverse, working-class community that faces a severe vulnerability to gentrification.
- Housing tenure is heavily skewed, with a massive **65%** of residents renting their homes.
- The compounding factors of a 65% renter rate and a **40% low-income rate** mean that new TOD amenities will directly price out existing residents unless strict housing affordability protections are enforced.



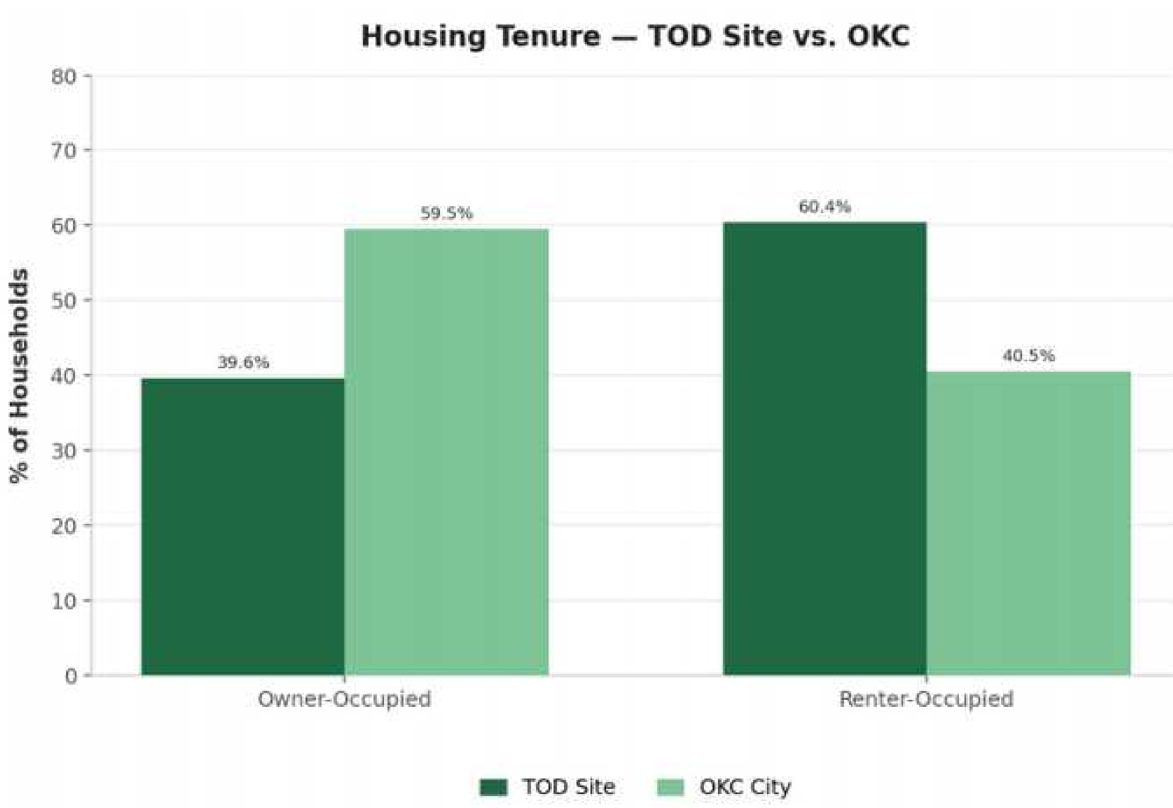
Our TOD site is similar to OKC's overall racial and ethnic composition. However, the site has a higher share of White residents (64.4%) than the city overall (58.4%), while Black residents are notably underrepresented. While the TOD area is not dramatically different from OKC, it's still important to consider equity in that transit-oriented development should intentionally improve access, affordability, and mobility for everyone, not just specific demographics of people.



The site's age distribution shows a higher than average number of young folks, potentially representing a higher mix of students and young adults. Conversely, the site has a relatively low percentage of those ages 65 and older. This means that a mojority of development and services should be geared towards students and working aged adults, as well as provide modes of care for the high population of residents under the age of 15.

HOUSING PRESSURE

A renter-majority corridor faces heightened displacement risk as TOD investment arrives.



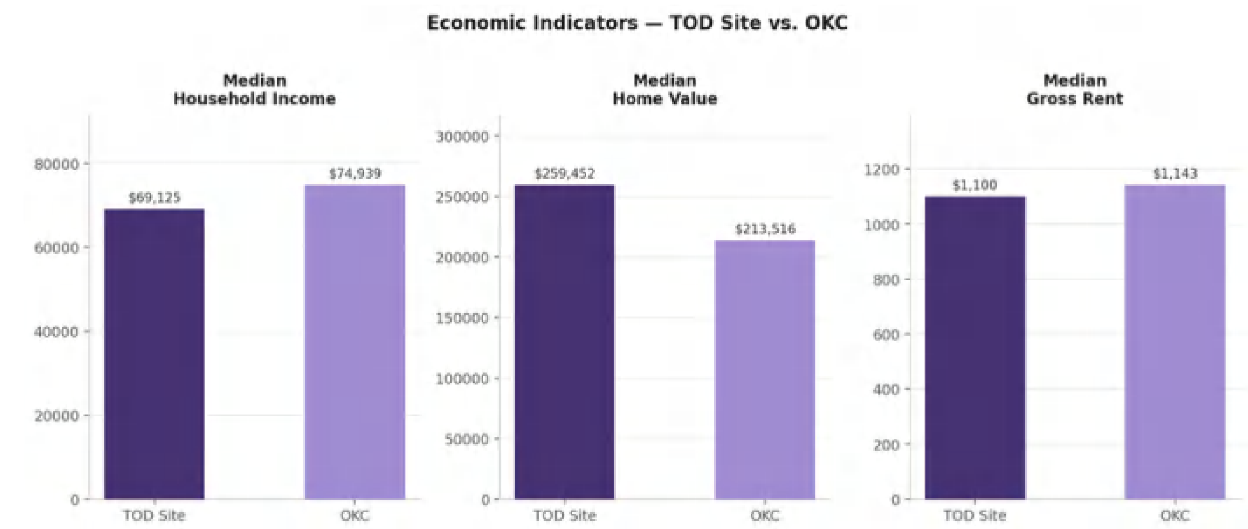
60.4%
renters

$69K
income

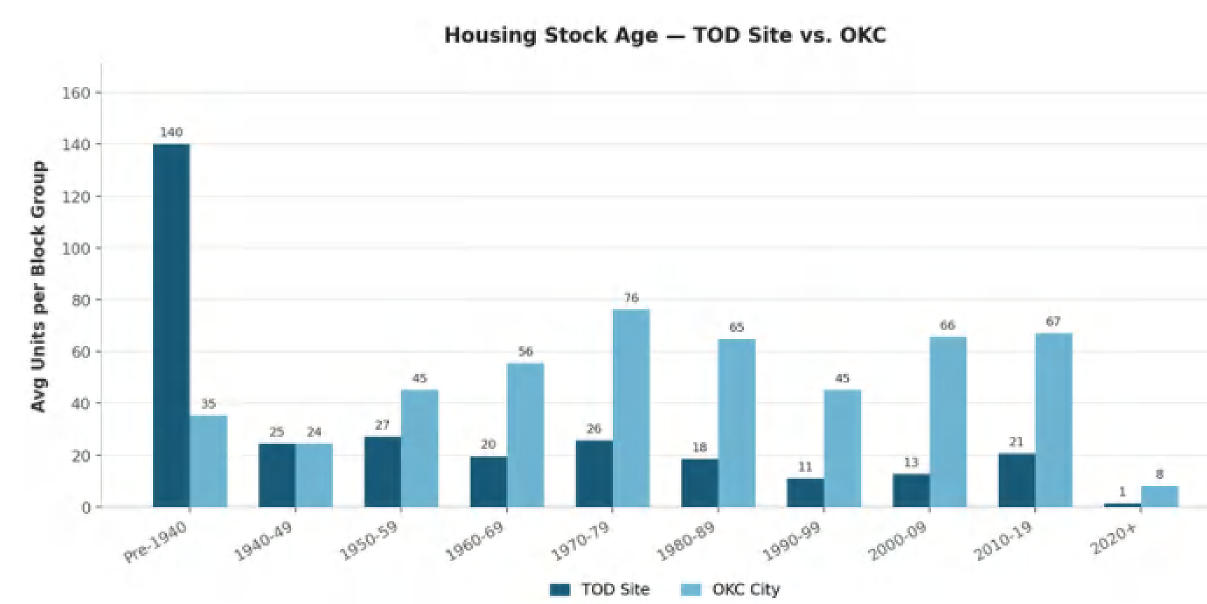
$1,109
rent

The above graph shows a comparative analysis of housing tenure for the transit-oriented development site versus the rest of OKC. As can be seen above, the TOD site is home to a comparatively higher percentage of renters, with 60.4% of homes along the corridor being renter occupied. Renters are significantly more vulnerable to displacement due to development-induced increases in property values. There are many tools to prevent displacement along the corridor. This plan calls for mandatory inclusionary zoning to ensure that existing residents on not priced out. Additionally, this plan will entail the preservation of existing affordable housing along the corridor.

The median home value for the TOD site is higher compared to OKC. This factor is likely to worsen with increased development along the corridor. Given that median household income is slightly lower than the city as a whole, steps need to be taken to prevent displacement and keep median gross rents down.

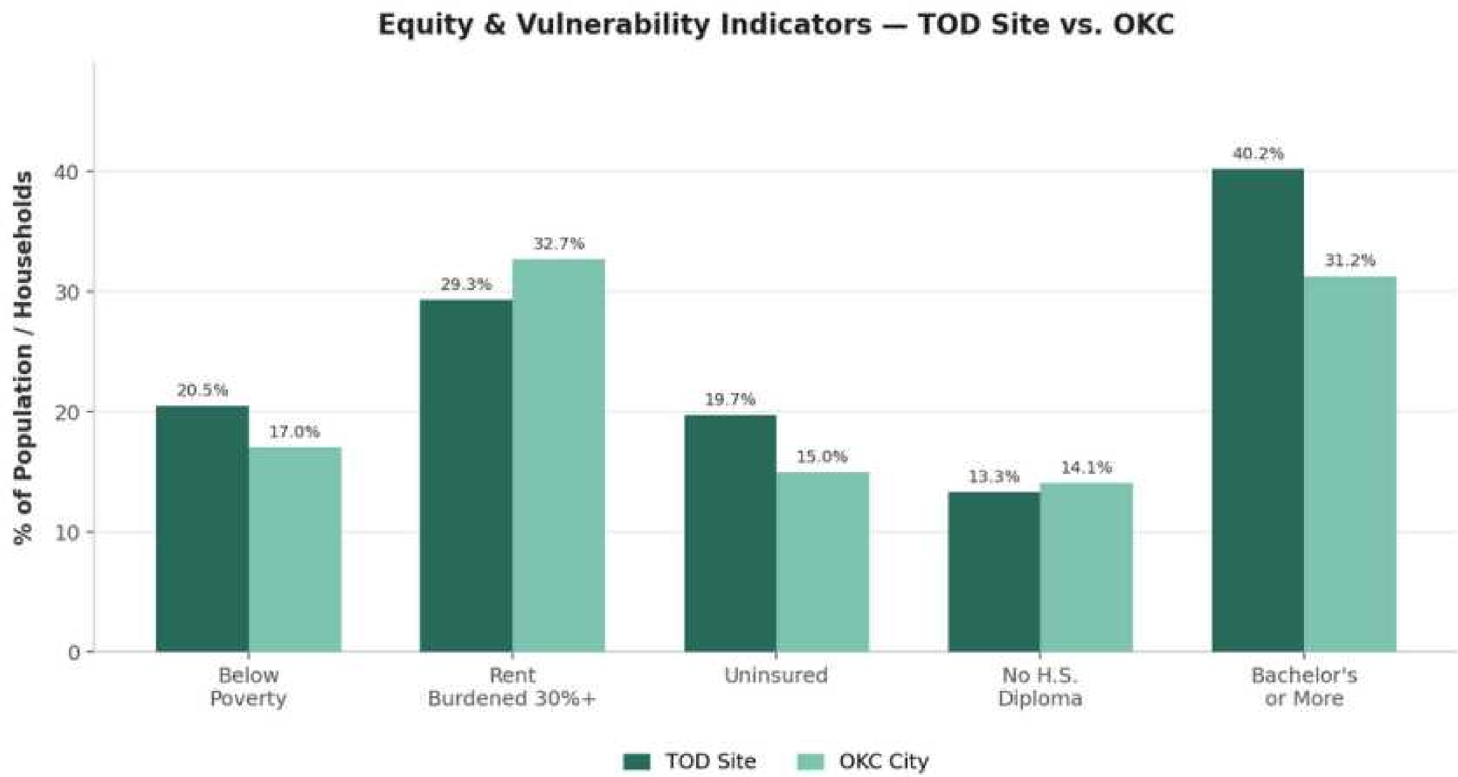


The housing stock along the TOD corridor is significantly older compared to the rest of OKC. Therefore, steps will be taken to refurbish the existing housing stock and possibly replace older housing with newer, denser, transit-oriented development.

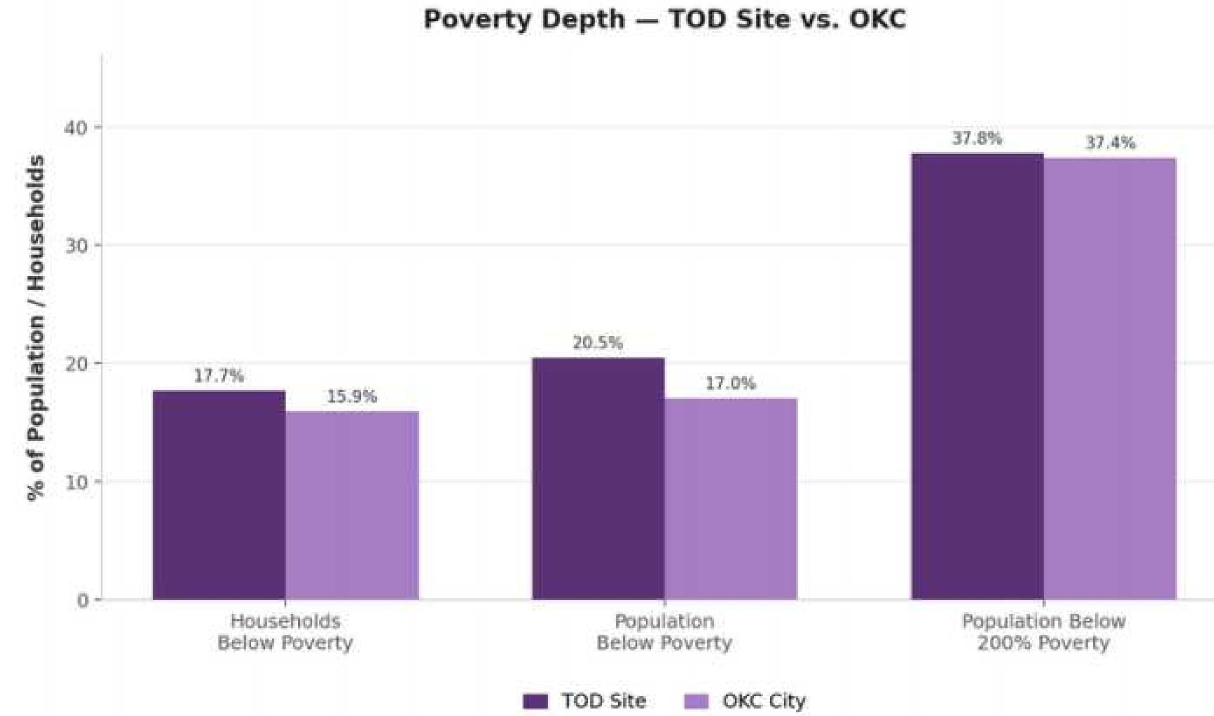


VULNERABILITY STACK

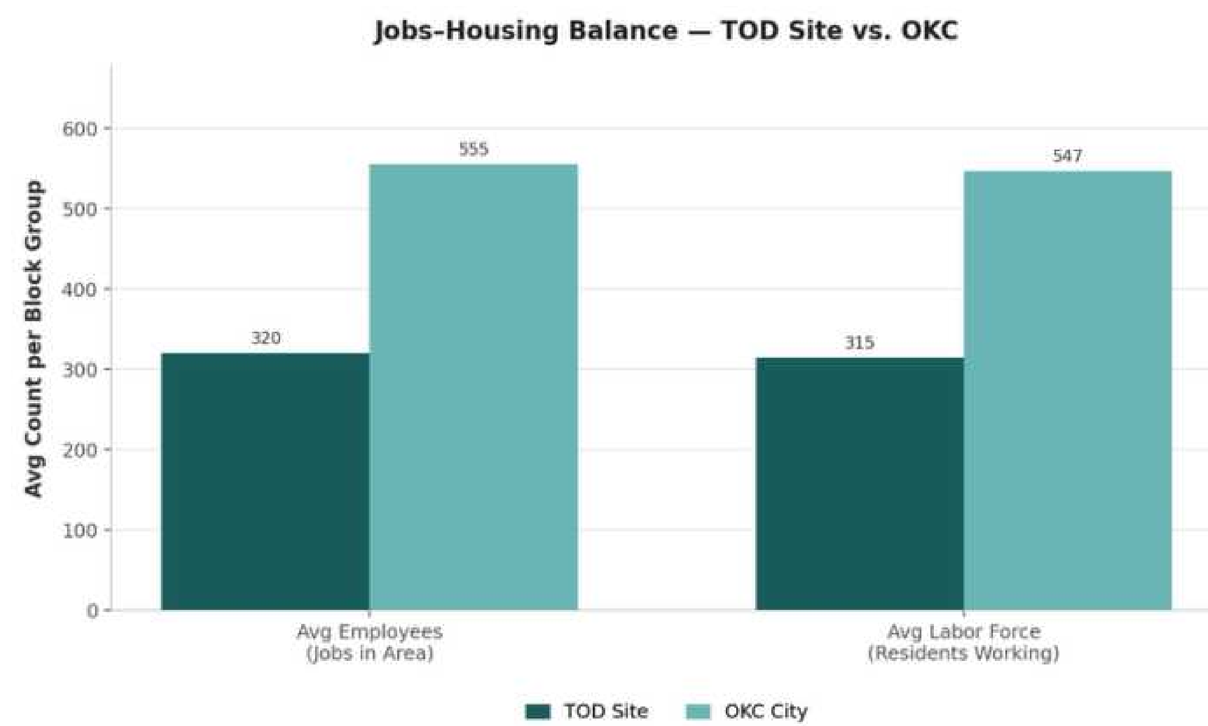
Pressures compound on corridor residents.



Vulnerability indicators are factors used by demographers and policy makers to measure how vulnerable a population is. This diagram shows that our site has a higher than average percentage of individuals below poverty rate and without insurance, but also higher rates of eduction and lower rent burden than the city average, painting a more nuanced picture of equity and vulnerability. This shows that development should focus on preserving affordability and preventing resident displacement.



This chart shows that the residents of our site tend to experience poverty at a slightly higher rate than the rest of Oklahoma City. When this is narrowed to extreme poverty, the results are nearly the same.



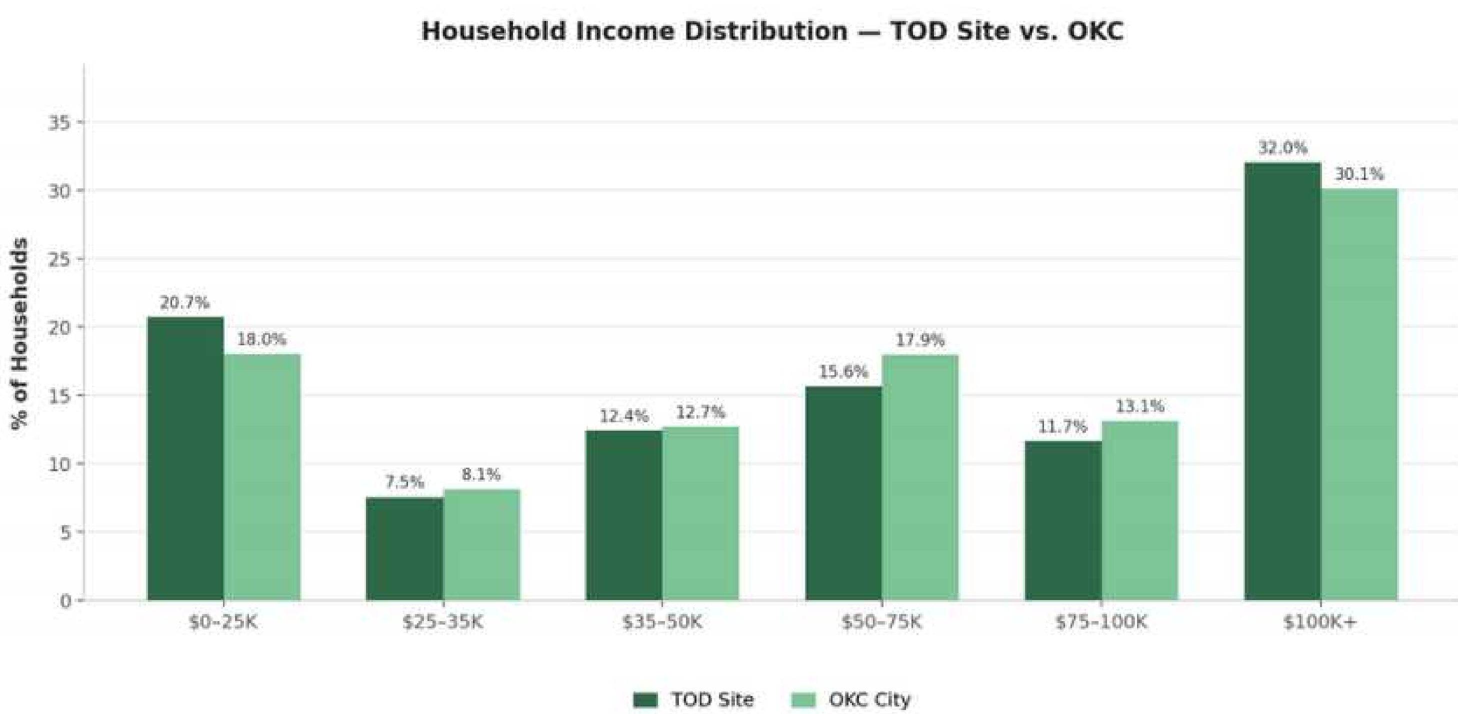
This chart shows that there are significantly less jobs per block group present near Classen Boulevard than elsewhere in the city. This represents the opportunity for development to increase density and provide additional jobs for residents.

ECONOMIC CONDITIONS

- The greater Oklahoma City area contains 427,100 jobs. Our specific compact study area firmly holds 16,643 jobs. This targeted zone serves as a **massive economic anchor** for the region.

- The citywide chart shows a highly **diversified industry spread**. The corridor data reveals a severe spike in retail and food services. This extreme reliance creates a vulnerable workforce earning lower wages.

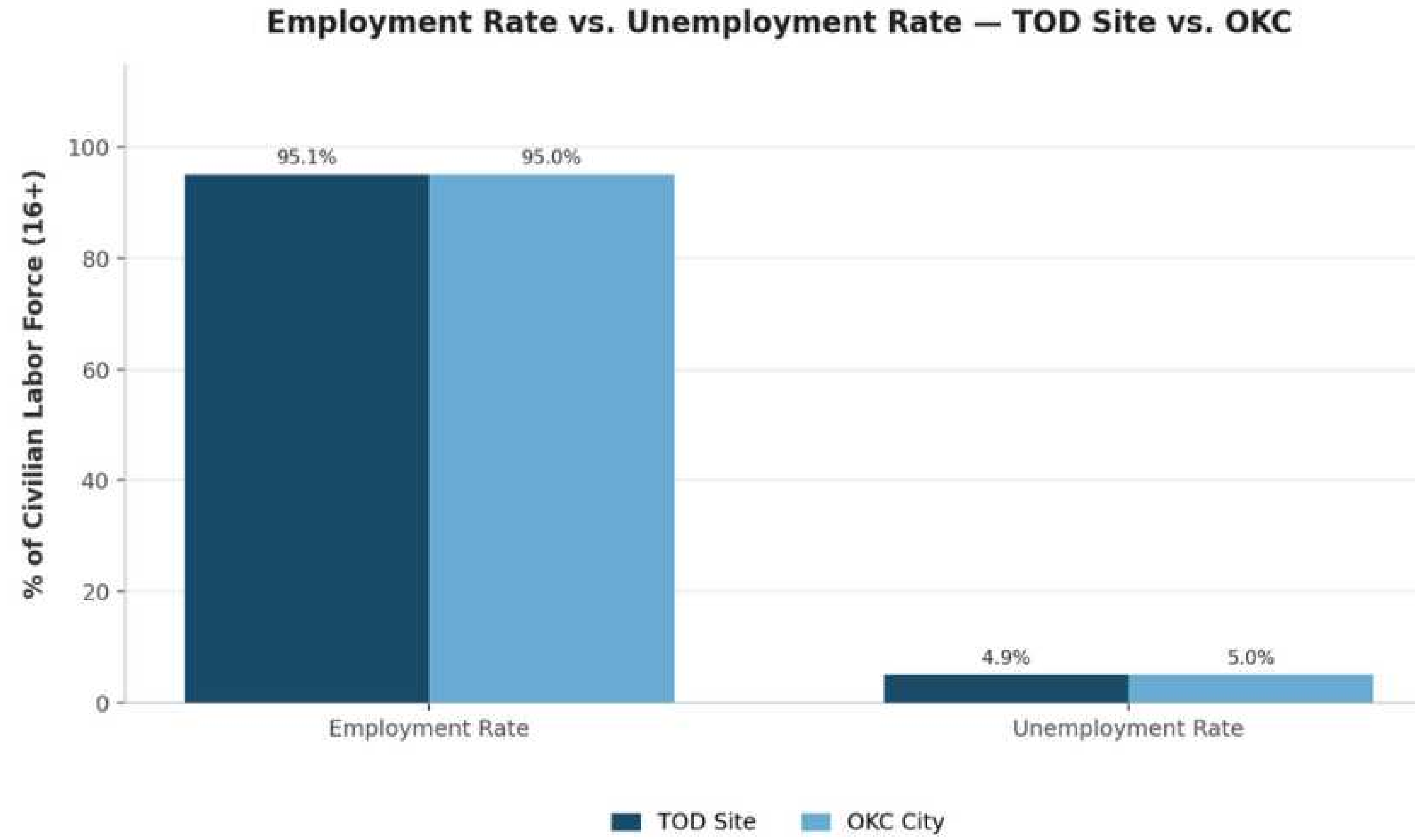
- The sheer volume of active workers justifies robust transit funding. New developments must include **tenant protections** to prevent the displacement of the essential workforce that sustains this local economy.



95.1%
employment rate

4.9%
unemployment rate

40%
earn under $50K

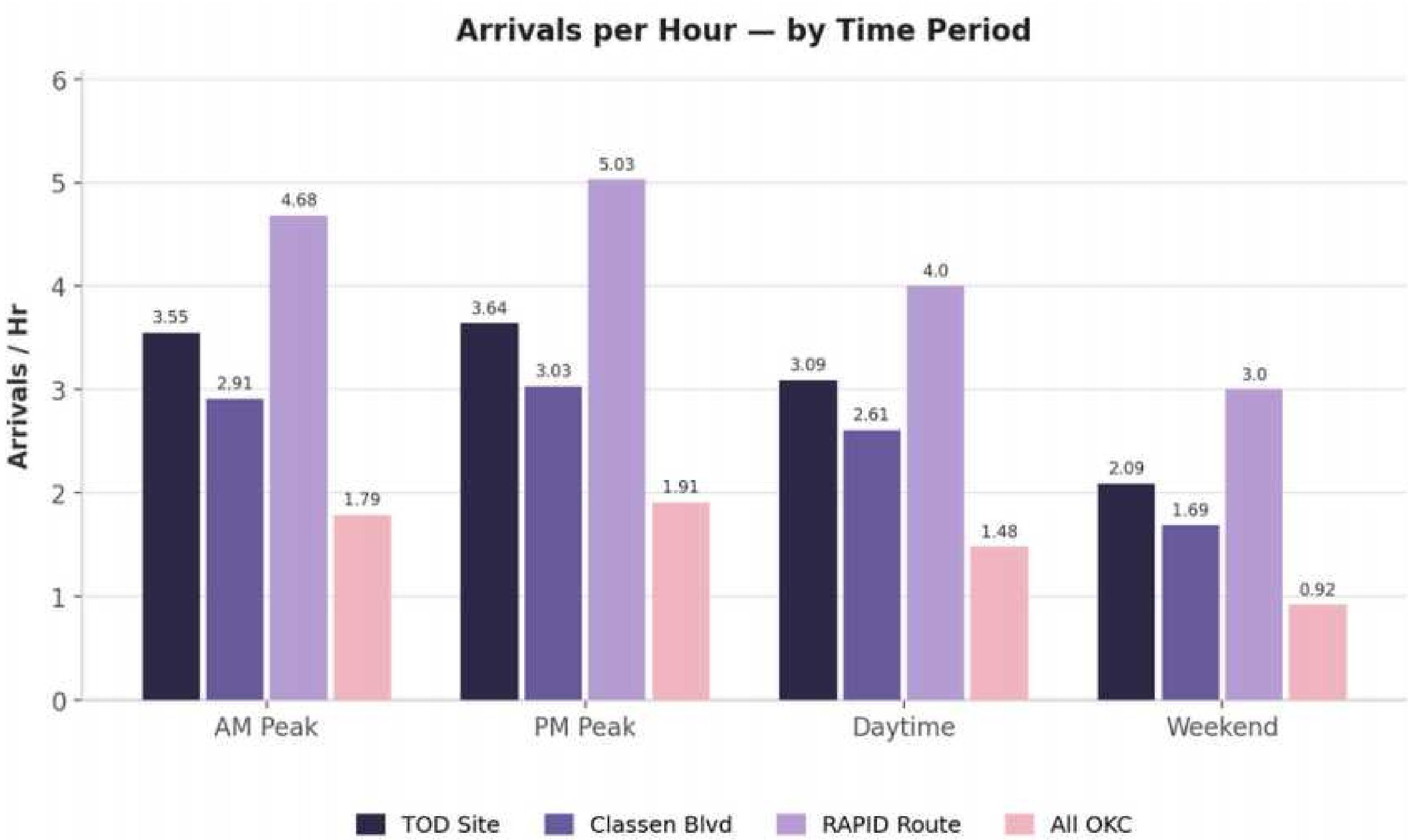


(Above) Those living in proximity to Classen Boulevard tend to have the same employment outcomes as the city average, with an unemployment rate nearing 5 percent.

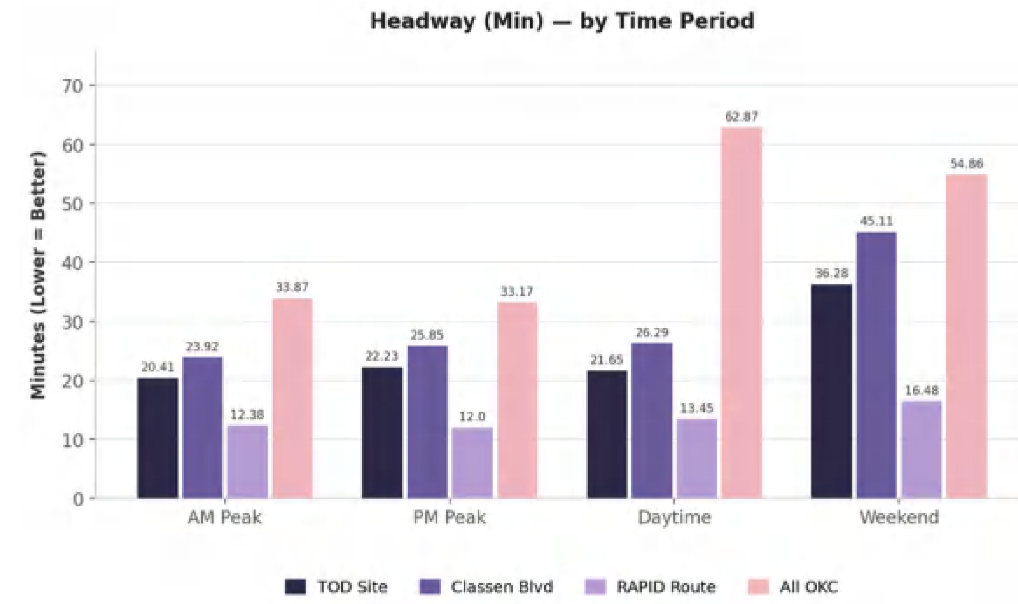
(Left) The site is notably mixed-income with 40.6% of households earning less than 50,000 dollars a year and 43.7% earning more than 75,000 dollars a year compared with the city’s average of around 68,000 dollars a year.

TRANSIT

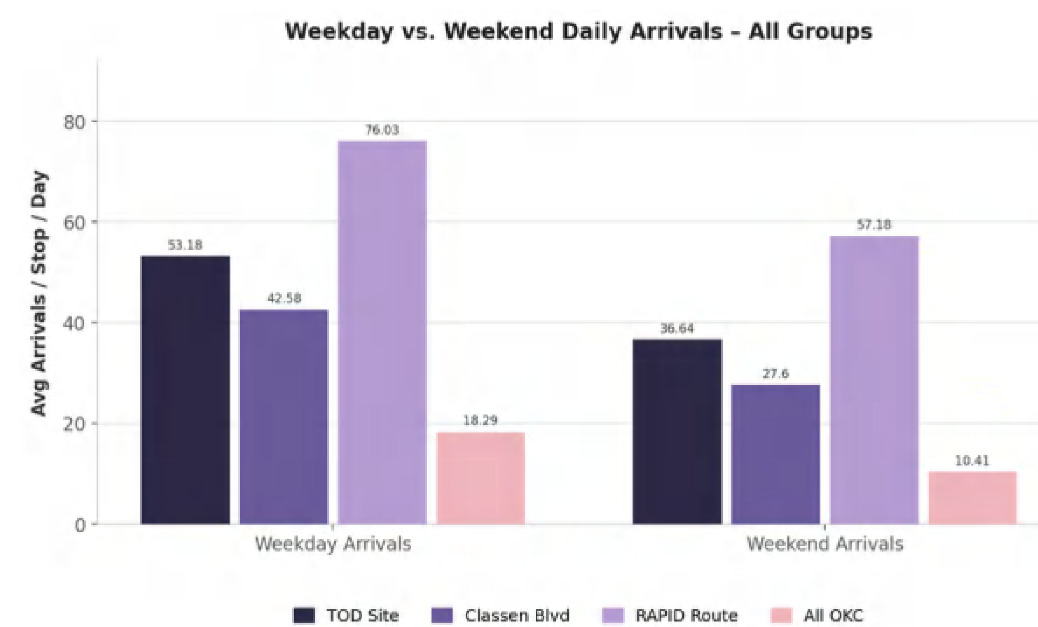
These maps outline several characteristics of the transit on the project site as a whole, Classen Boulevard specifically, the entirety of the RAPID route, and OKC as a whole. This data is used to better understand how our site can be improved to set a BRT precedence across the region.



The RAPID route has the most arrivals as it includes Classen Boulevard. This chart can primarily be used to visualize the peak times of ridership. This chart reveals that the most arrivals occur in the peak of the afternoon on weekdays, so future scheduling should meet this demand.



This chart shows more divergence between study areas. Notably with our site preforming significantly better than the OKC average with lower headways across the board. Especially in the daytime outside of peak hours. However our site is relatively less successful in minimizing headway on weekends.



An important consideration when developing a bus schedule is how frequent routes should be during the week when primarily serving commuters versus on the weekends when service is more oriented towards recreation and shopping. This chart reveals that our site has more traffic during the week, so less emphasis needs to be put on providing the same frequent service over weekends.

TRANSIT NETWORK

The Oklahoma City Metro Area's existing transit network is run by Embark, the largest transit agency in Oklahoma. The network consists of 17 fixed route bus services that operate seven days a week, five weekday-only routes, two downtown streetcar loops, and a ferry line along the North Canadian River.

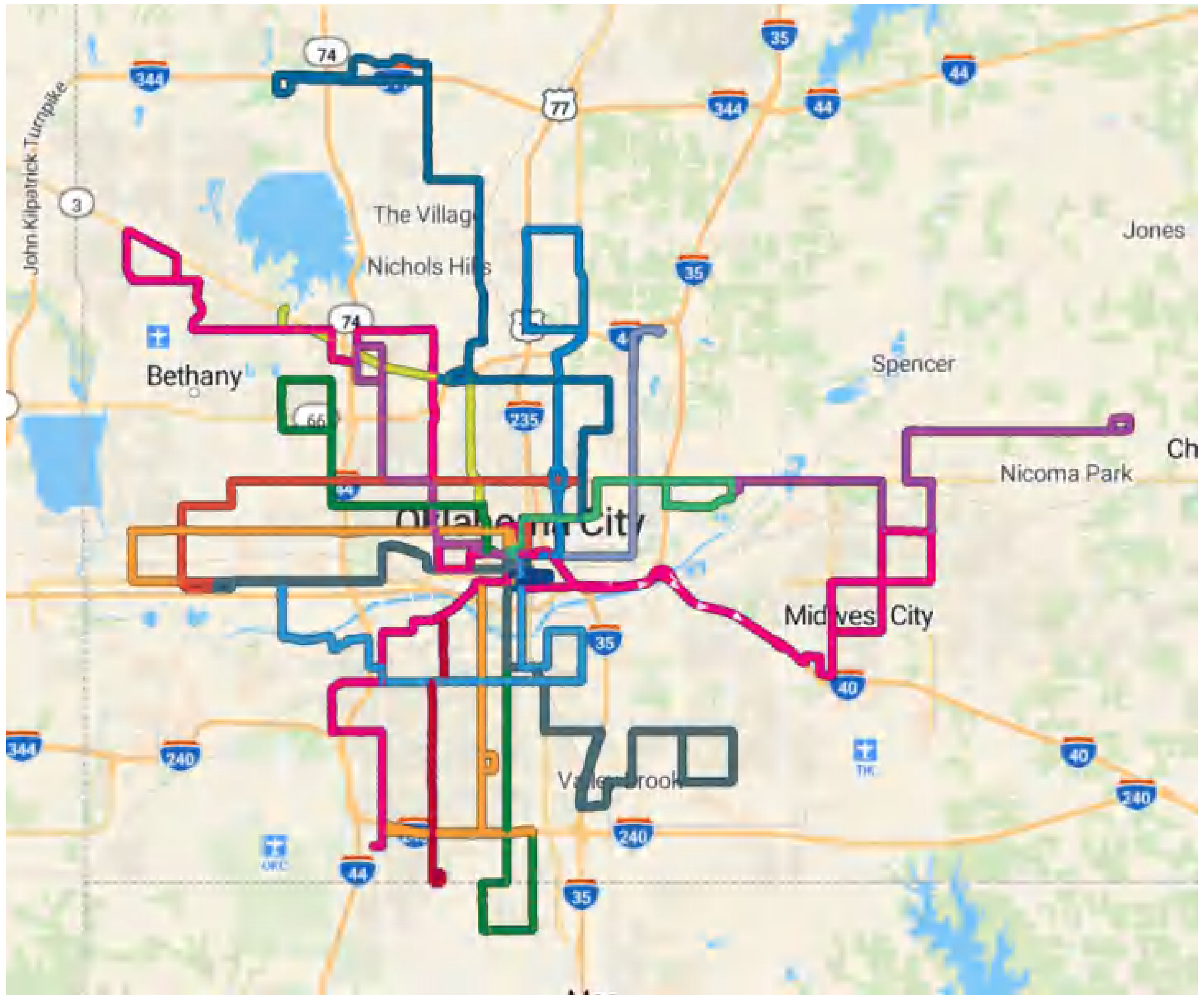


Figure shows all current bus service in OKC with the green-yellow line serving our site, which acts as the corridor's crucial transit spine. Its success heavily relies on urgent frequency upgrades across the intersecting network.

The most relevant transit services to Classen Boulevard include the fixed route bus services that intersect with the corridor, existing bicycle infrastructure, and the RAPID. The major fixed route bus services that intersect with the corridor include the 005, 007, 008, 010, and 023. The 023 is an especially important route, as it laterally connects Oklahoma City University (OCU), a major trip generator for the corridor, more directly to the RAPID. The frequencies of these bus services (the RAPID excluded) leave much to be desired, as buses on most routes generally arrive every 25-30 minutes on weekdays and every 50-60 minutes on weekends. Such routes are generally even more limited during evenings and nights, with service frequencies weakening dramatically after 7:00PM.

BIKE NETWORK

Oklahoma City's bike infrastructure, though growing, is also severely underdeveloped. Bike routes in the city are generally classified according to the three main categories: bike lane, shared route, and multi-use trail. Bike lanes vary in quality, but generally entail the delineation of road space (through paint and other barriers) exclusively for the use of bicycles and other modes of active transportation. The highest quality bike lanes feature buffers to separate bike traffic from automobile traffic, offering a higher level of safety for all road users. Shared route corridors offer no such delineation. Mutli-use paths are generally separate from existing road infrastructure, and therefore offer a high level of safety for users.

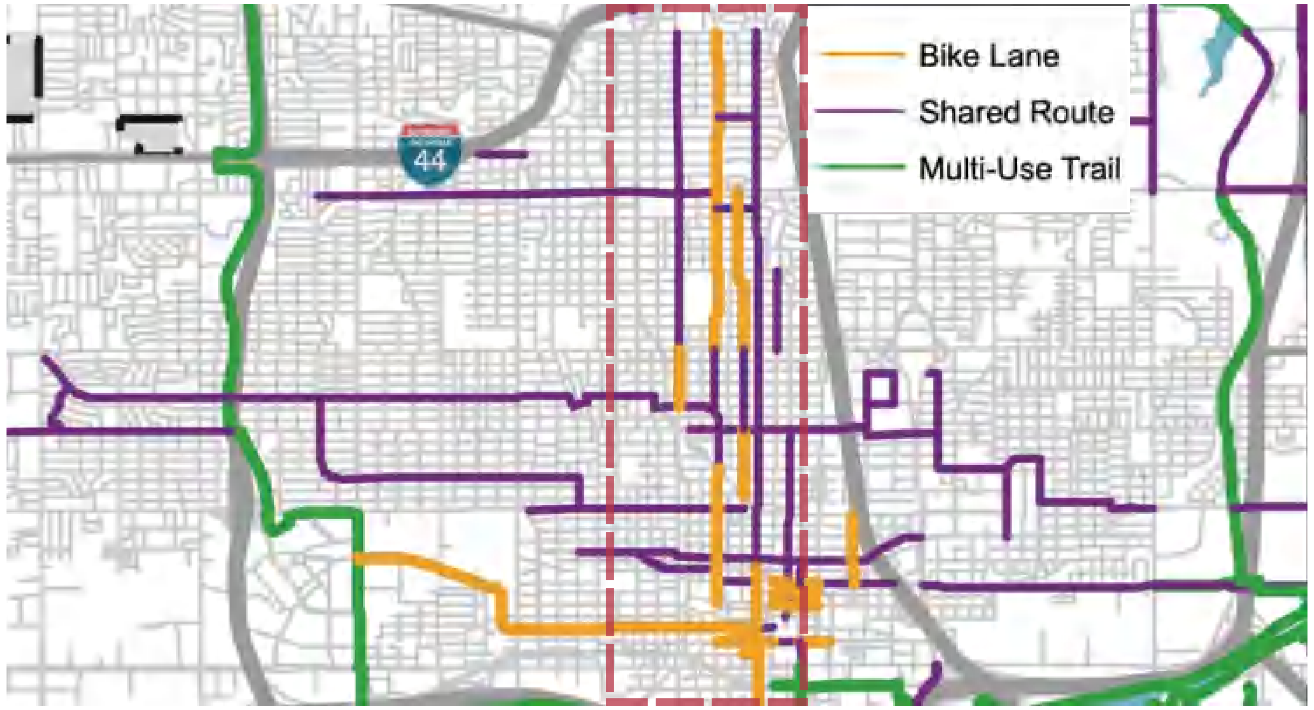
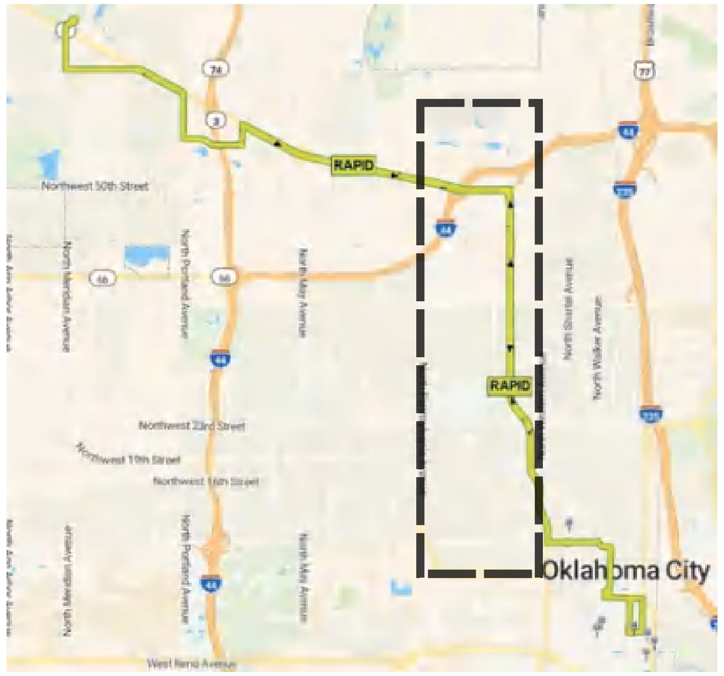


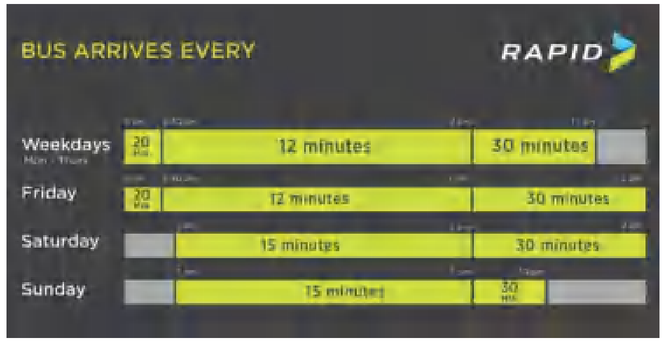
Figure shows all current bycicle infrastructure near the corridor's area.

RAPID TRANSIT

For the purpose of this transit-oriented development plan, we will be focusing primarily on the RAPID as it is the spine of the corridor and yields higher ridership compared to the rest of the transit system. The RAPID, though initially projected to receive 1,000 riders per day, averages around 1,400-1,500 riders per day as of December 2025. Per 2025 data, the system averages around 9,000 riders per weekday. Thus, the RAPID constitutes around 15.5%-16.6% of the system's total ridership.

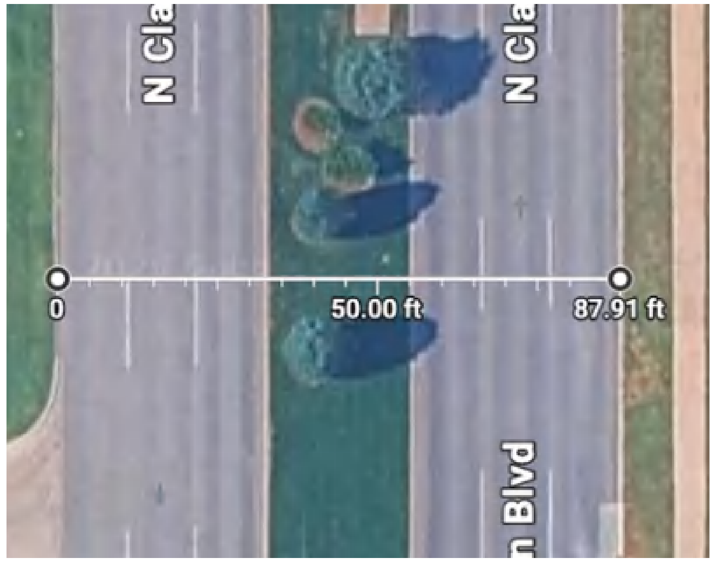
The RAPID, as described by Embark, is a bus rapid transit (BRT) line that runs 9.5 miles and has 32 stops in both directions. The route runs from Downtown Oklahoma City along Classen Boulevard, the Northwest Expressway, and other various nearby streets to connect major employment centers before terminating at a park-and-ride just south of Lake Hefner. The line utilizes Transit Signal Priority (TSP), which is a tool that gives priority to transit vehicles at intersections by modifying traffic signals, thereby increasing bus speeds along the corridor. The RAPID features 12-minute peak frequencies (6:30AM-7:00PM) on weekdays and 15-minute peak frequencies (7:00AM-7:00PM) on weekends. The full RAPID schedule can be seen in the figures below:

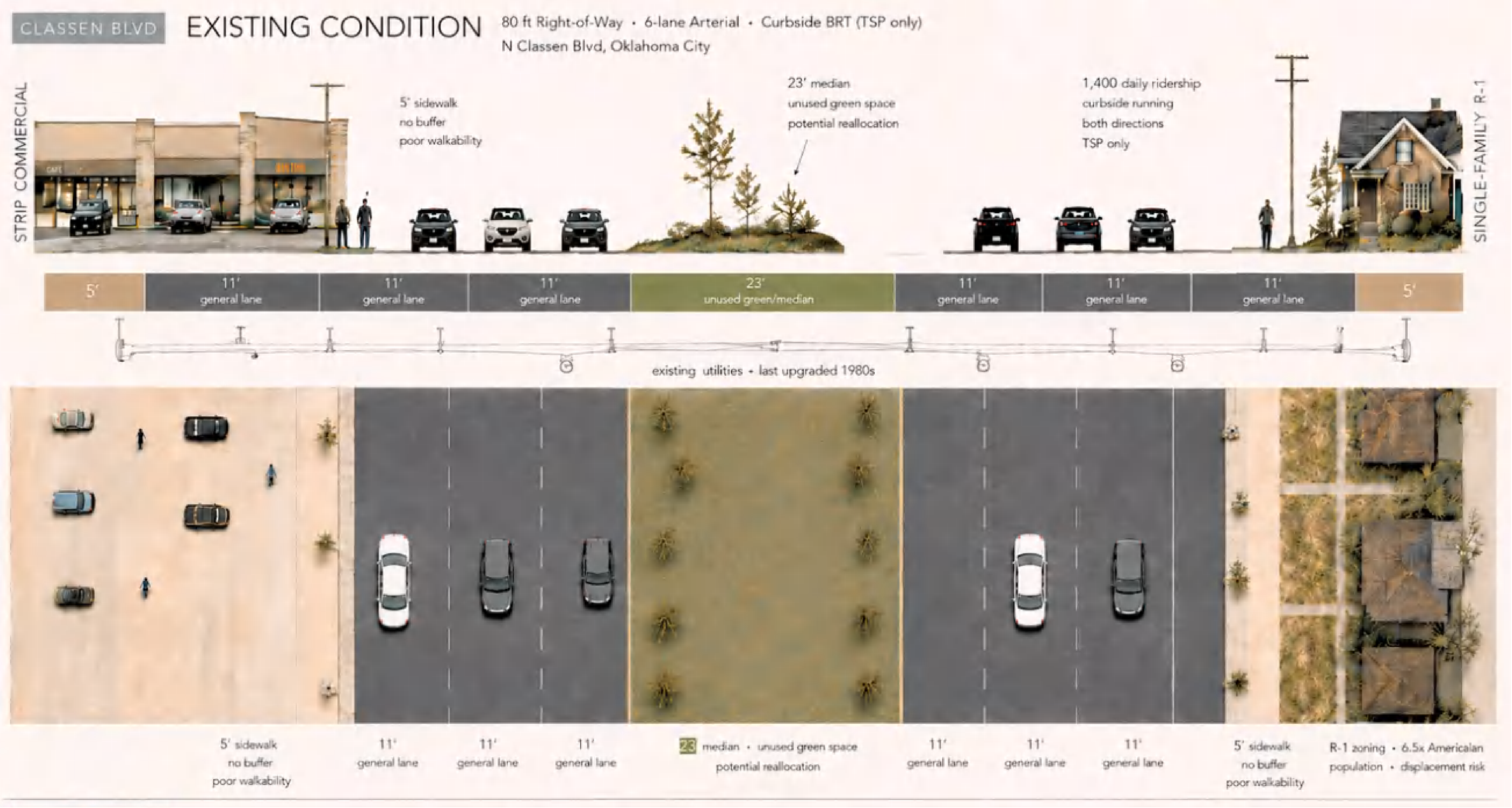


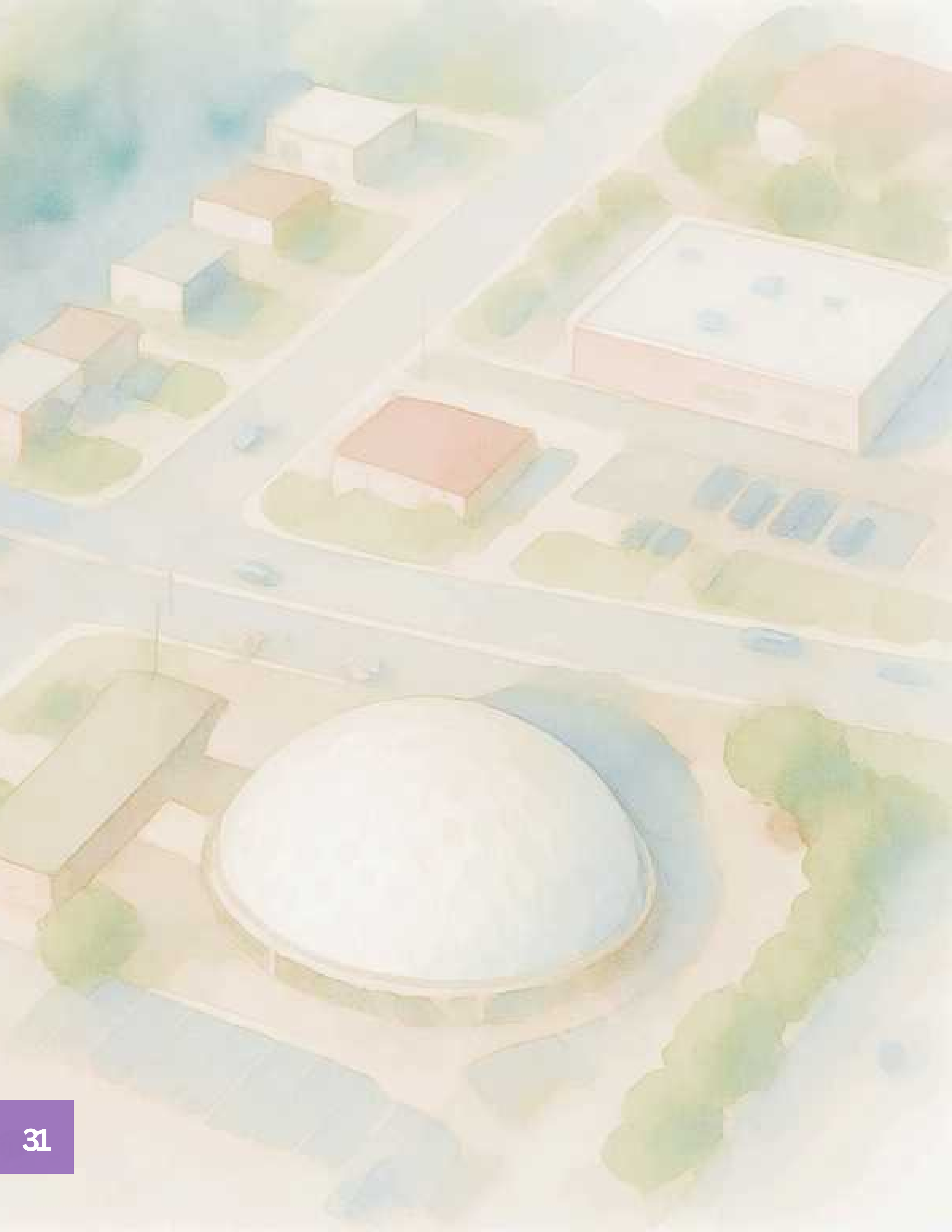


CLASSEN'S STREETSCAPE

The majority of Classen Boulevard features a wide median with three lanes of vehicle traffic in both directions. The road is 80ft-90ft wide in most sections (excluding sidewalks), as can be seen in the figure below. The median planting strip is around 15ft-20ft wide in most sections, and usually is occupied by grass but sometimes features landscaping in certain sections. In the southern section of the road, the right of way has been narrowed down to two lanes in each direction to provide space for a protected bike lane on the shoulder.





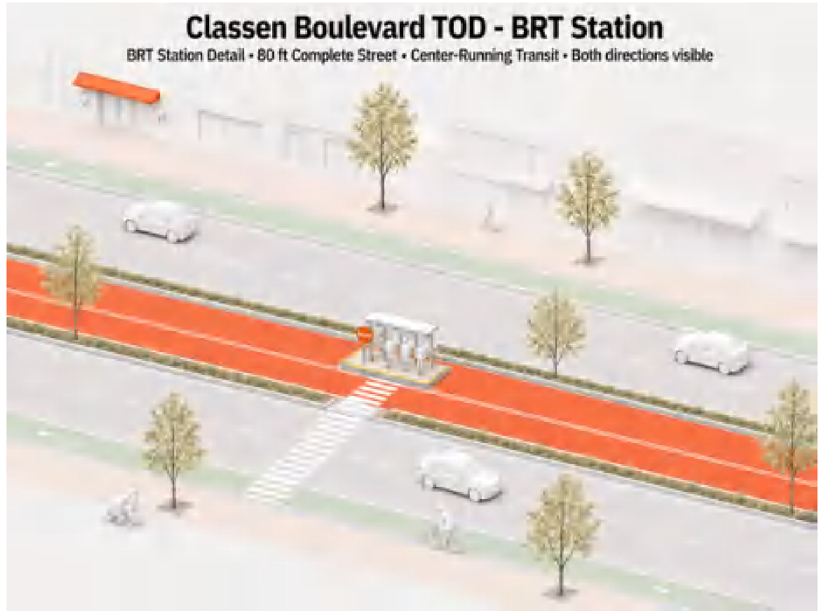


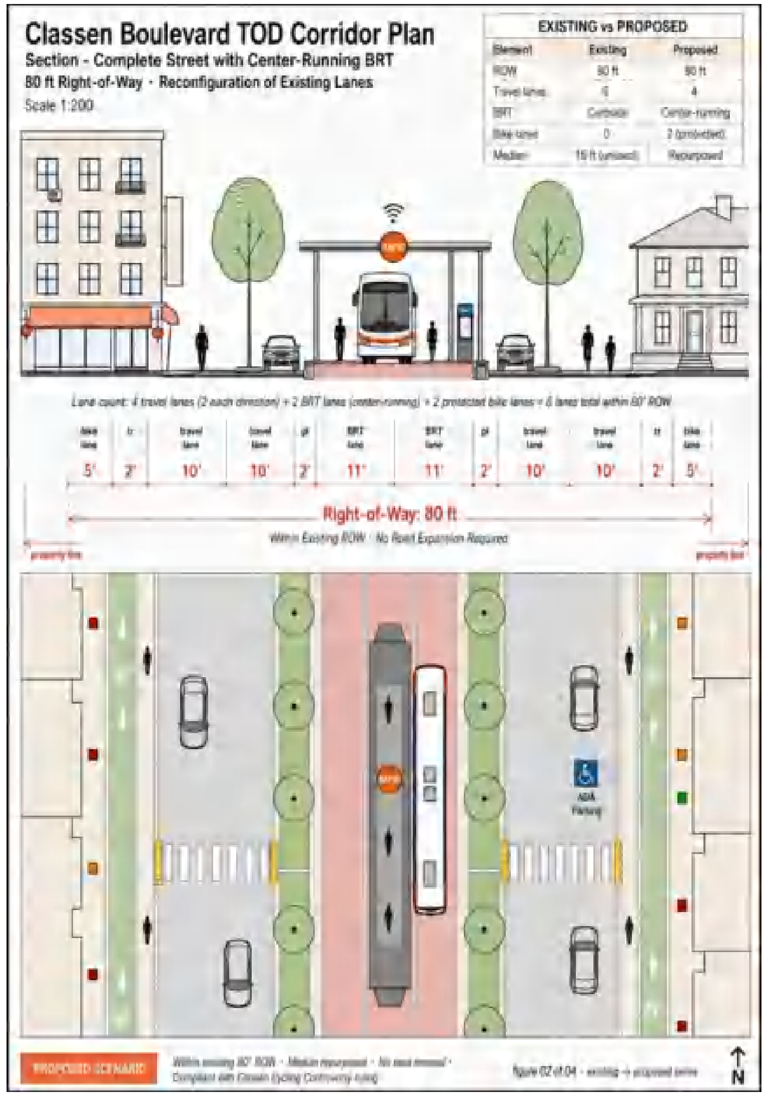
CLASSEN BOULEVARD IMPROVEMENT PROPOSALS

TRANSIT IMPROVEMENTS

OVERVIEW

Transportation and land-use are two sides of the same coin, and density necessitates improved transportation. Changing Classen Boulevard’s streetscape is necessary to improve the RAPID line. Classen Boulevard’s wide right of way makes it easier for significant changes to be made in its streetscape. Though the existing bus rapid transit line is a significant improvement from a conventional bus service, as indicated by its ridership, there are many steps that need to be taken in order to support the kind of dense development put forward in this plan. Increasing density and transit accessibility can also serve to alleviate the burden of transportation costs from low-income residents. Riding transit is comparatively cheaper than using a private vehicle, especially given the volatility of gas prices.





These two diagrams highlight center running BRT lanes. Physically separating transit from mixed traffic is the critical design intervention to guarantee BRT speed and reliability.

ITDP TOOL

The Institute for Transportation and Development Policy (ITDP) has developed an evaluation tool based on international best practices to improve bus rapid transit systems, especially those in the United States that have not lived up to international standards. Classen Boulevard does not currently have dedicated bus lanes, which is necessary in supporting consistency and frequency along the corridor. Moreover, the RAPID’s existing 12-minute peak frequencies are not sufficient in supporting the plan’s desired dense development.

Dedicated Bus Lanes

Dedicated bus lanes are necessary in ensuring that traffic does not interfere with the existing bus route. When bus service is dependent on traffic flow, consistency of service is severely degraded. This element significantly weakens the quality of the RAPID service.

Increase Frequencies

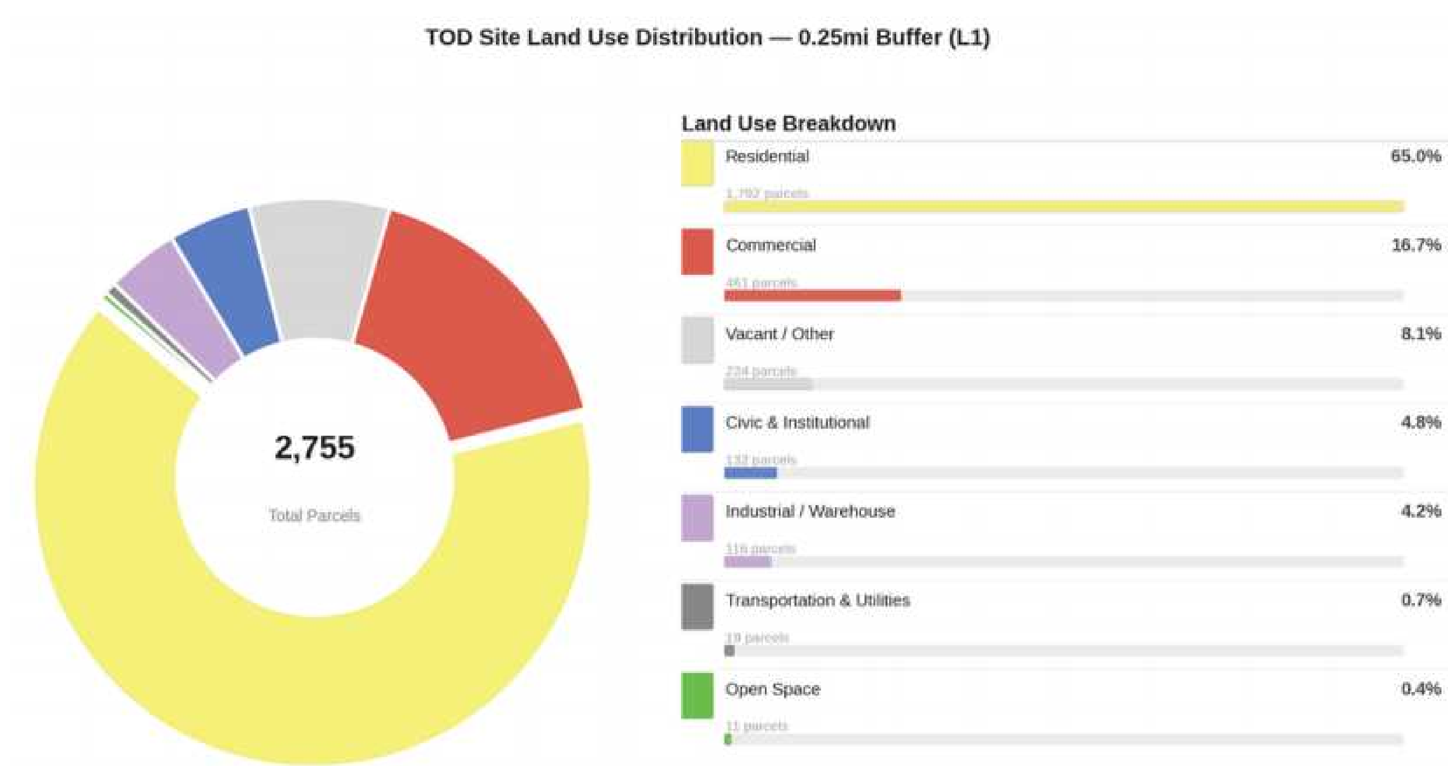
Increasing peak and off-peak frequencies on the service is not only necessary for increasing capacity - as density will increase the amount of people using the service - but is also necessary in improving the rider experience. Lower wait times lead to more positive perceptions of public transit. The ITDP recommends increasing frequencies to 10 buses per hour - or a bus roughly every 6 minutes. Additionally, off-peak frequencies should be increased to at least 15-minute headways.

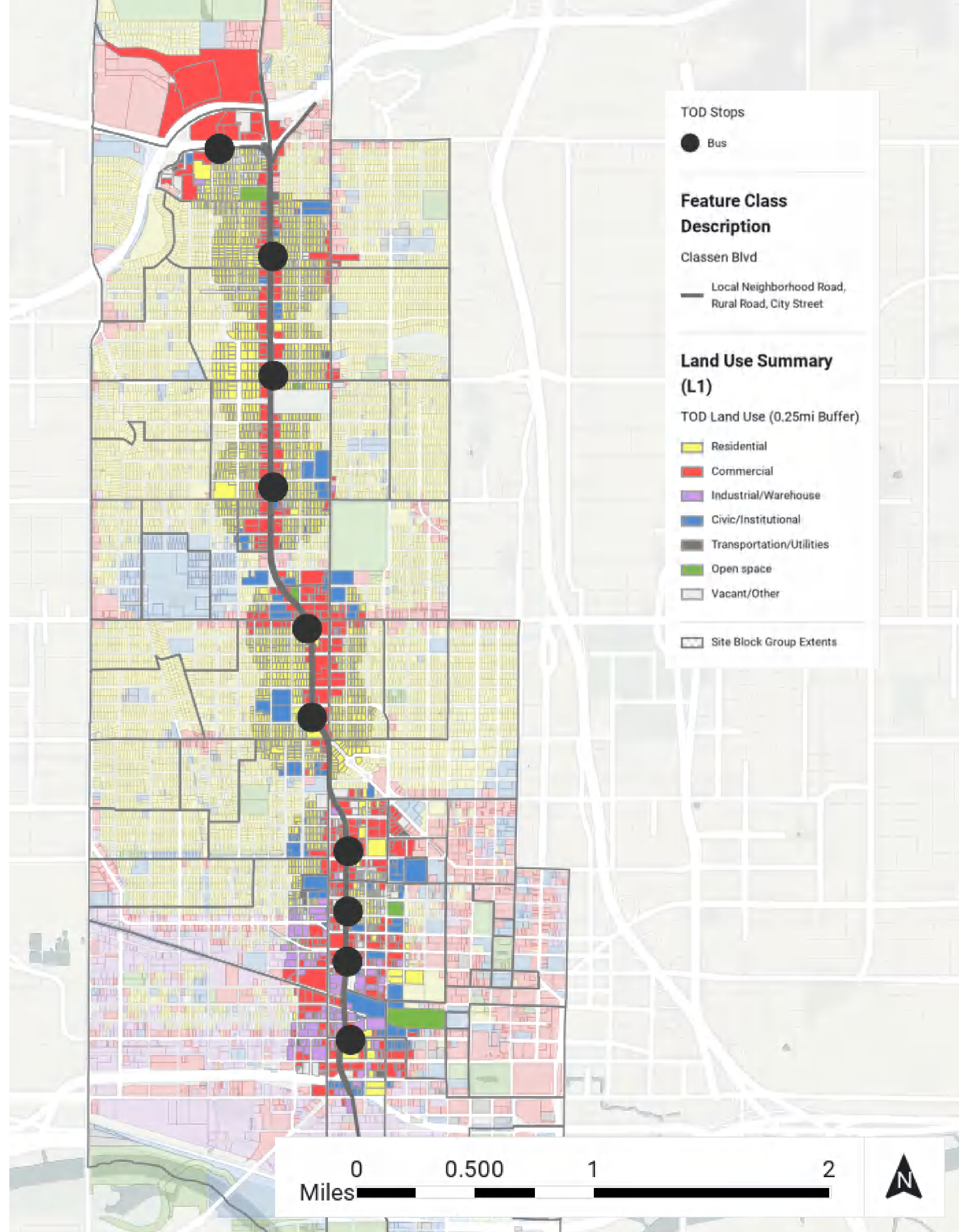
Expanded Hours

The RAPID should aim to operate past 12:00AM on weekdays and 2:00AM on weekends. This expanded service makes living along the corridor and relying on the service more convenient for residents, which encourages transit ridership and discourages car-ownership.

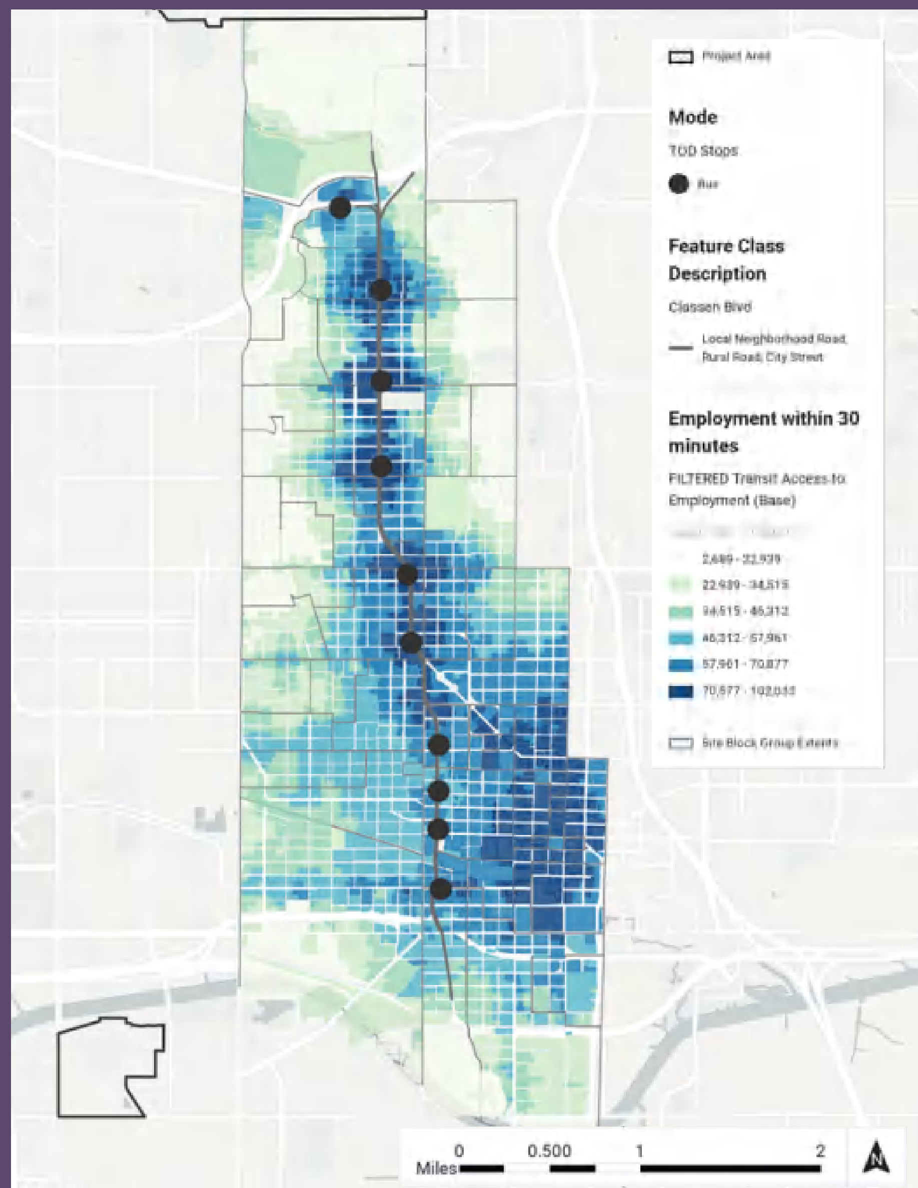
BASE SCENARIO

This base scenario illustrates a 0.25-mile buffer around the 11 bus stops along Classen Boulevard in our small area plan. The 0.25-mile buffer is significant because it represents a 10 to 15-minute walking radius to each stop, showcasing which land uses are most accessible to transit riders. At the northern tip of the corridor sits Penn Square Mall, while the southern portion of the corridor is primarily industrial/warehouse and commercial in character, with some civic and institutional uses interspersed throughout. However, the largest share of land use both within the 0.25-mile buffers and across the small area plan as a whole is [single-family] residential. This raises the central question of the project: how do we best maximize land use within the 0.25-mile walking radius of each bus stop to ensure that this transit-oriented development is serving the greatest number of people while reaching the highest economic growth potential for the corridor?



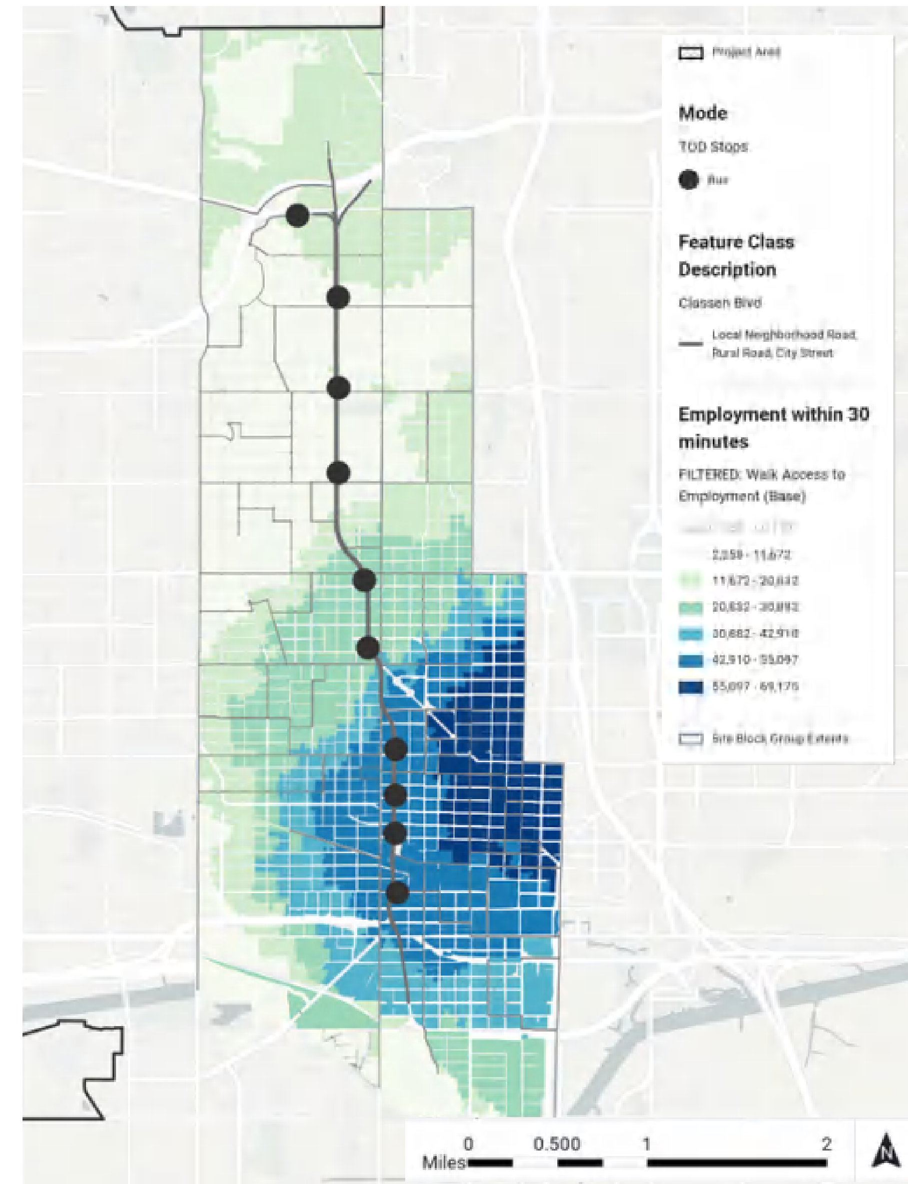


TRANSIT ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)



As can be seen above, the existing RAPID service is highly effective in making employment more accessible for those who rely upon public transit. The service runs through some of the largest employment centers in the city, including Oklahoma City University, Downtown, and the Penn Square Mall. Increasing density along this corridor not only provides an impetus for improving the BRT service that many currently rely upon, but also puts more residents closer to employment opportunities.

WALKING ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)

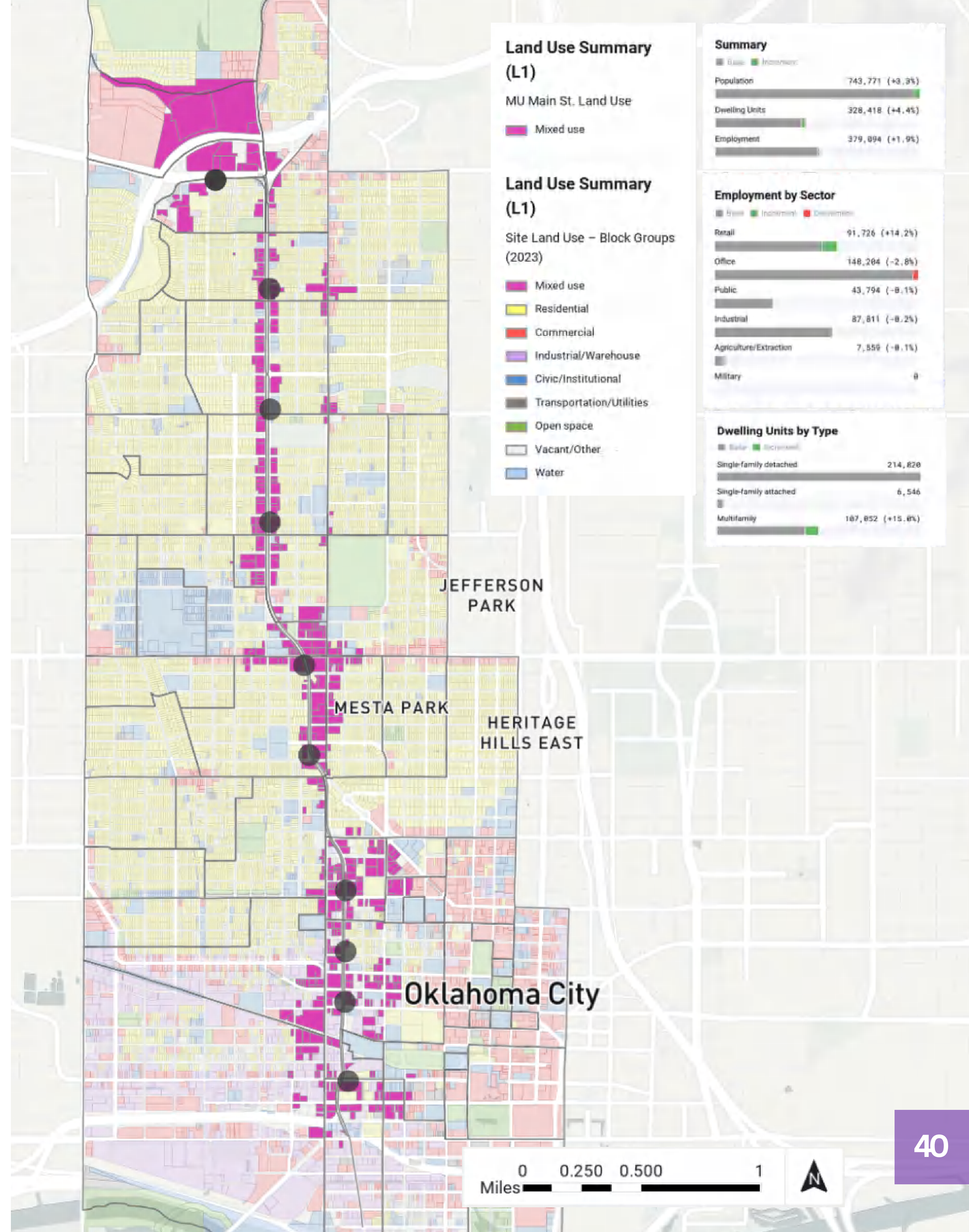


The map above displays which properties are within 30-minute walking access to employment opportunities. Employment opportunities are highly concentrated in downtown, with time to arrival radiating out from this central hub. Such an analysis demonstrates the importance of increasing density near employment, as well as connecting those employment centers to transit. Within this analysis, significantly less people have access to employment compared to the analysis with transit.

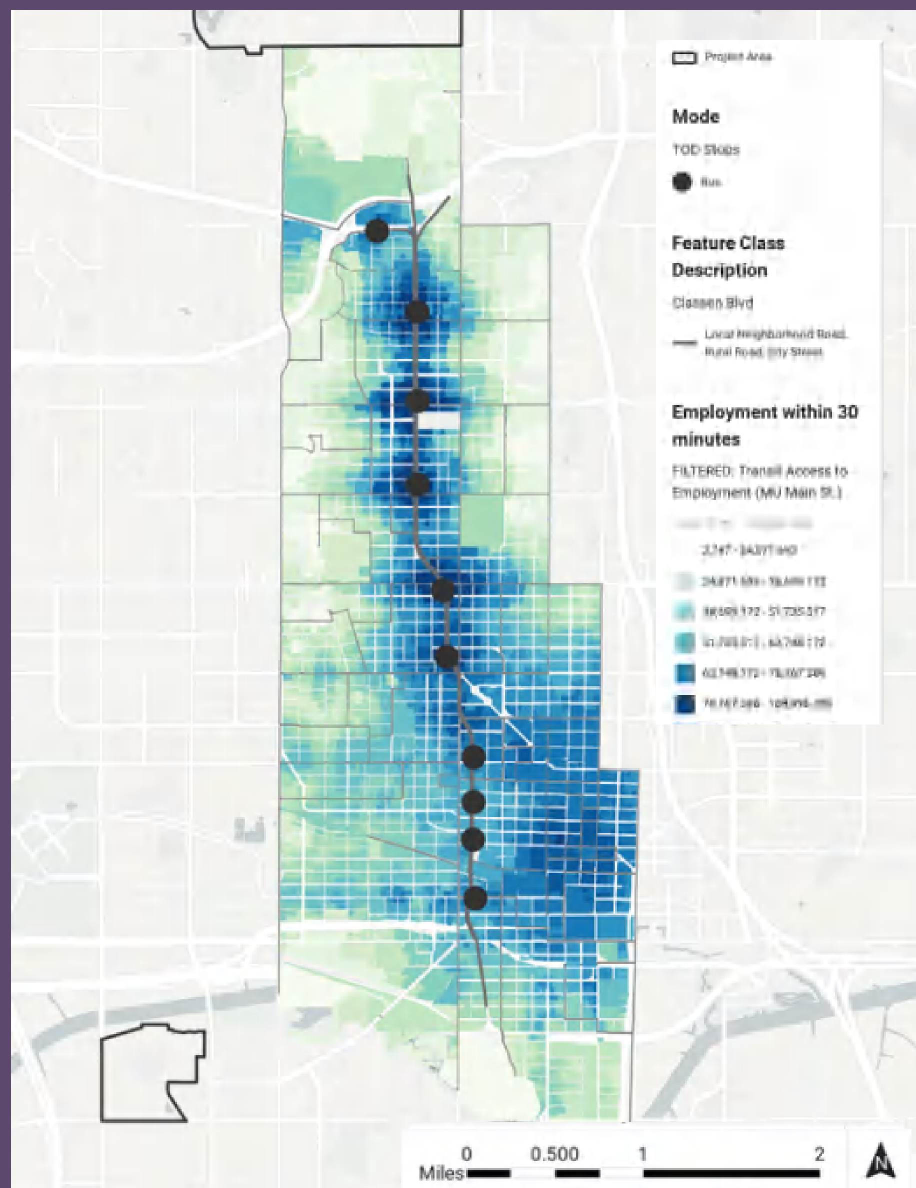
SCENARIO 1

The first scenario builds off of the base scenario by examining the commercial land uses within the 0.25-mile buffer of each bus stop along the Classen Boulevard corridor. As a result, this scenario proposes transitioning these areas toward a more economically productive and people-centered category: mixed-use development. Much of the existing commercial stock along the Classen corridor consists of small, one-story buildings characterized by large parking lots, oversized lot sizes, and highly specific, single-purpose uses. This scenario does not propose the large-scale demolition of commercial properties along the corridor, but rather considers a gradual reimagining of what these parcels could become. It envisions what the corridor might look like if its commercial land use base were incrementally expanded and enriched through mixed-use development over time.

A modeled rendering of potential mixed-use development in a vacant and underutilized parcel along the Classen Boulevard corridor.

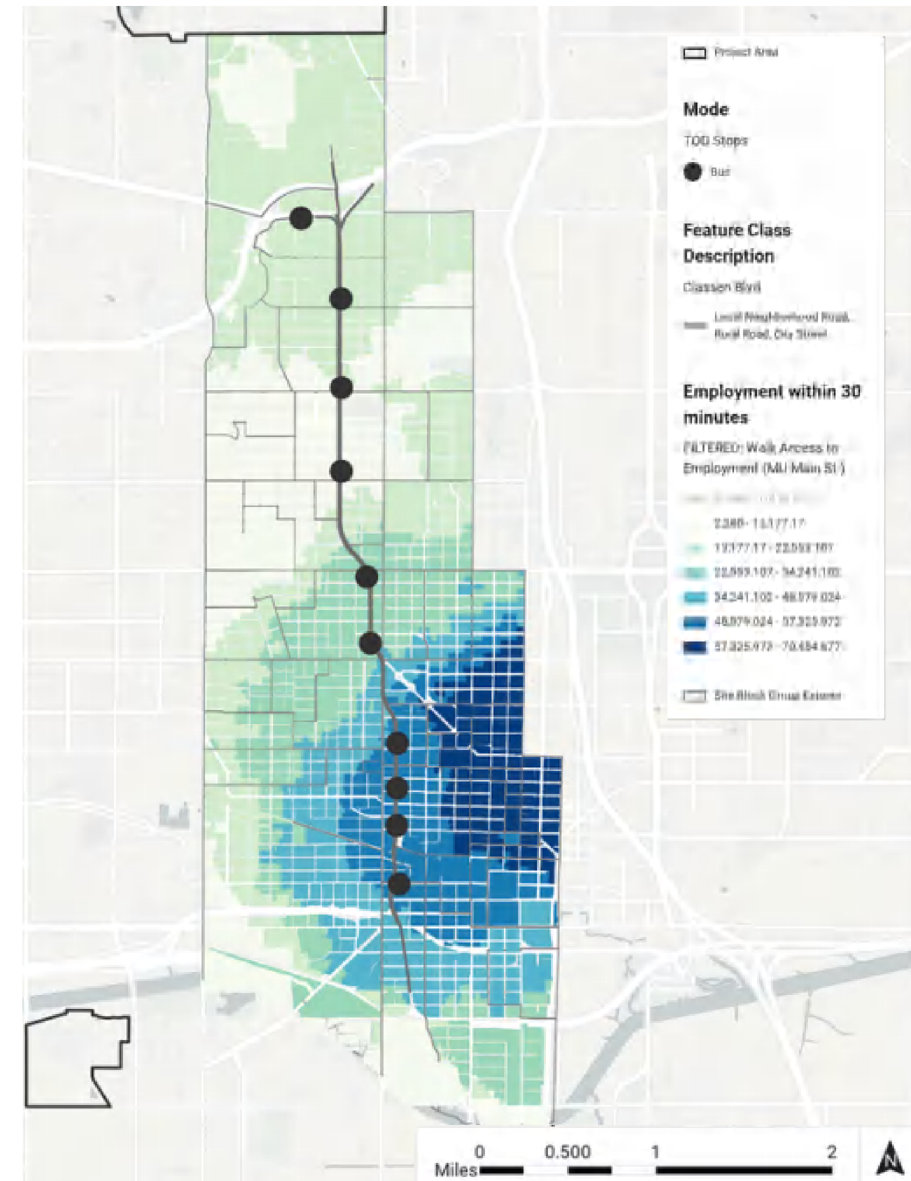


TRANSIT ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)



Developing mixed-use buildings in place of existing low-density commercial that is currently seen along the corridor increases the amount of people who are within access to employment by transit. Mixed-use development not only puts more housing close to transit stops, but also puts more jobs also close to transit. As can be seen in the graph above, amount of people within immediate access to transit has increased by about 6,000 residents.

WALKING ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)

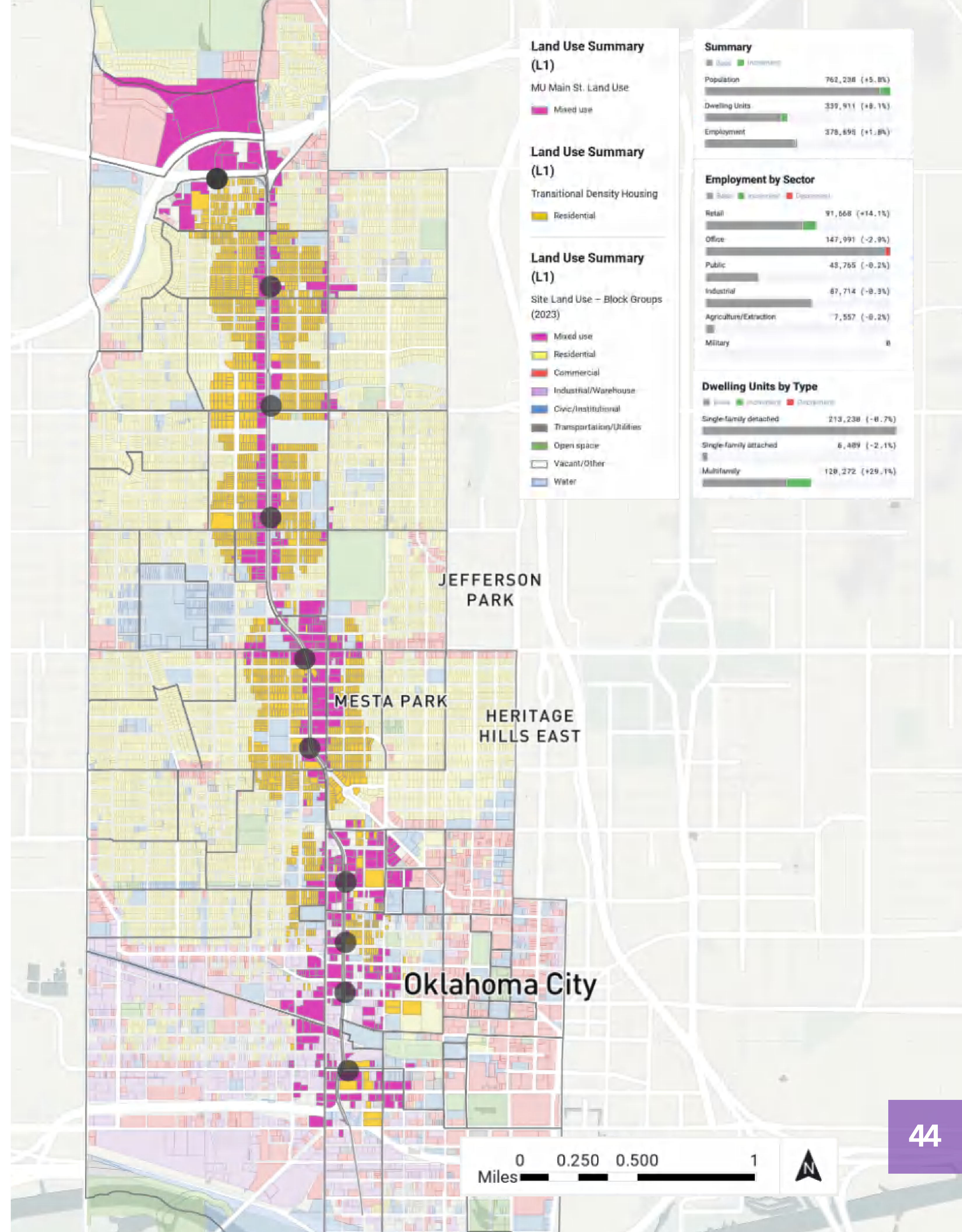


Walking access to employment in this scenario remains relatively similar compared to the base scenario. The main difference between the two is that more residents along the Southern end of Classen Boulivard are within walking distance of downtown due to increased mixed-use development.

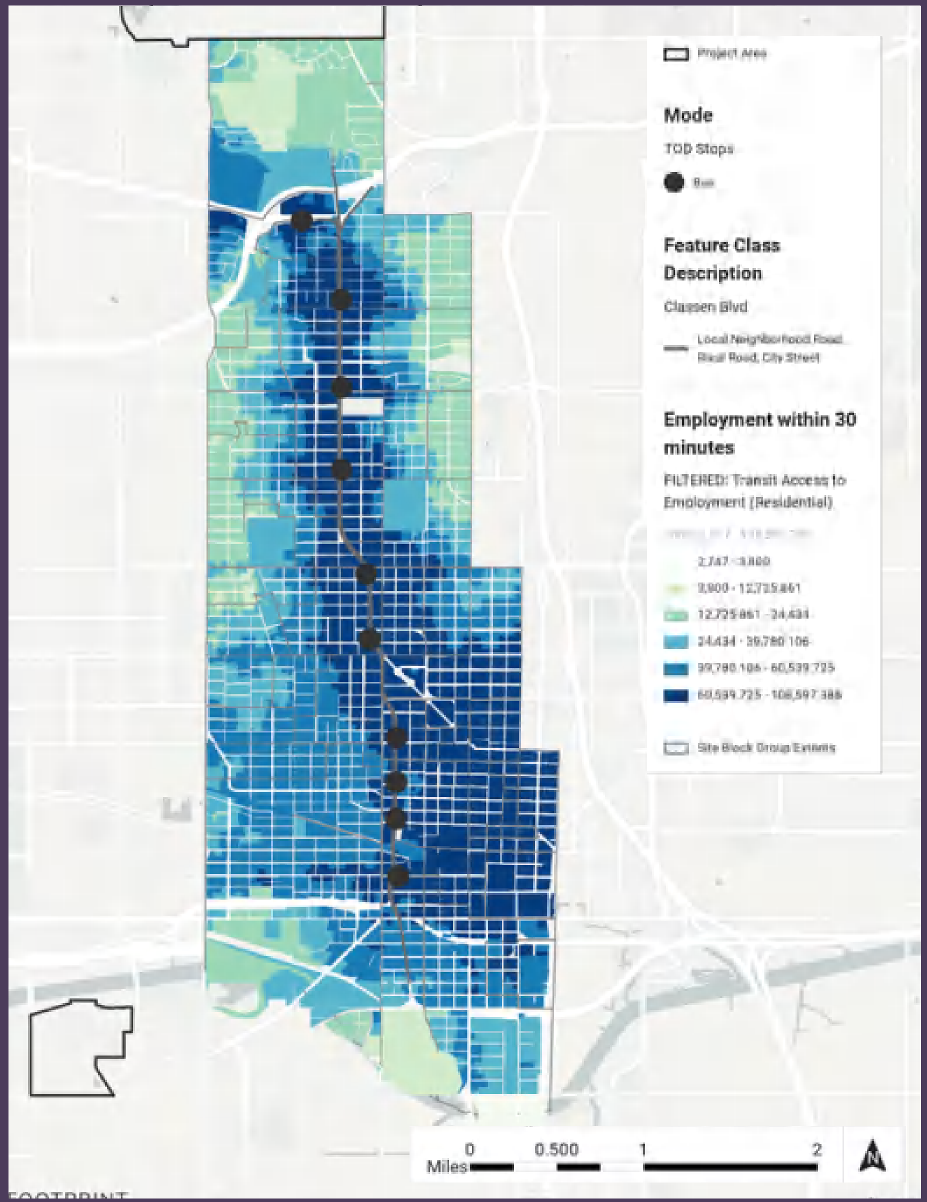
SCENARIO 2

Scenario 2 takes a similar approach to Scenario 1, building on its proposal to gradually incorporate mixed-use development in place of existing commercial properties, while also optimizing residential density throughout the 0.25-mile buffer of each bus stop. More specifically, this scenario proposes a transition toward more diverse housing typologies, including duplexes and compact multifamily housing. This is essential for transitional density housing, especially in areas of Oklahoma City where the dominant housing type is single-family residential. The approach of this scenario helps the Classen corridor because it preserves the neighborhood scale and character that defines the small area plan. However, it additionally increases housing density around the emerging economic opportunities created by mixed-use development and improved transit access.

A modeled rendering of potential duplex housing that could replace single-family homes occupying oversized lots, helping to densify and activate the Classen Boulevard corridor.

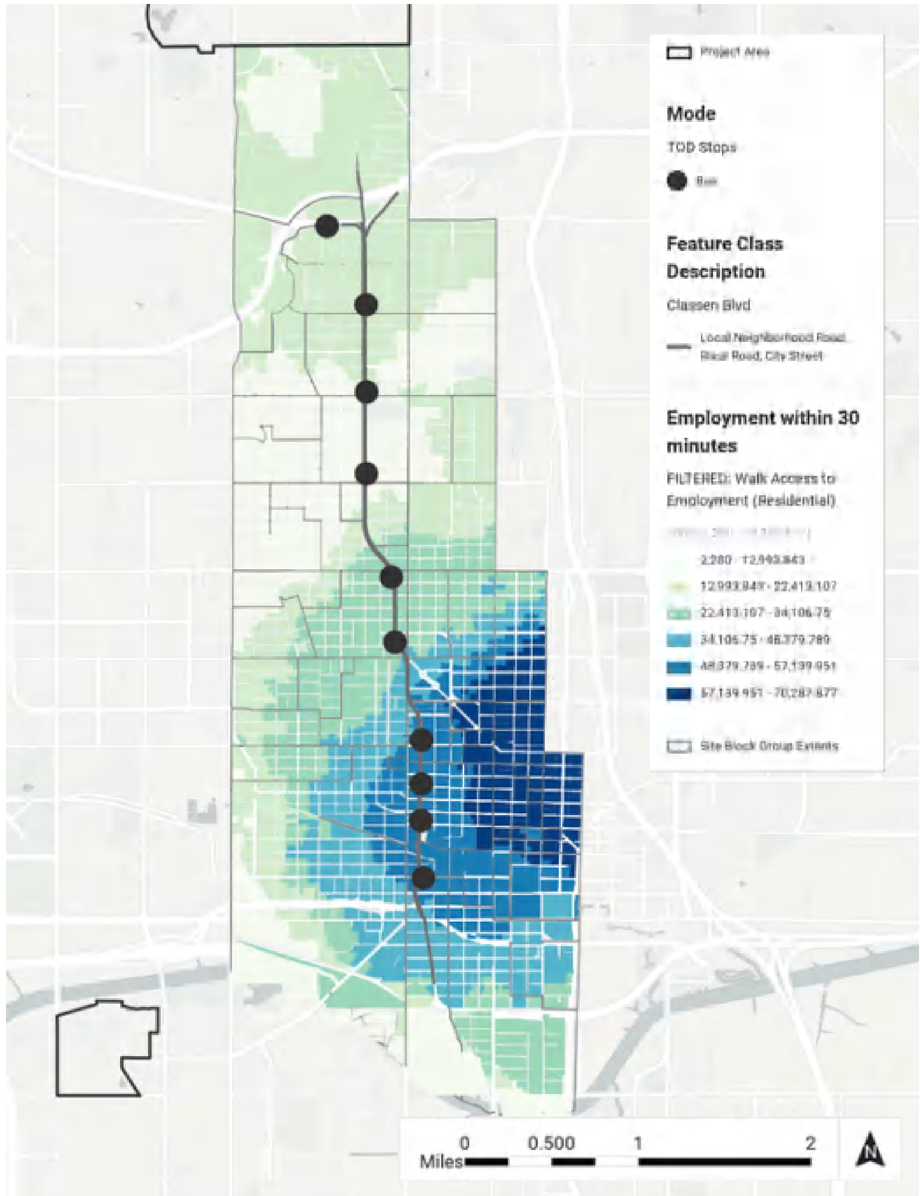


TRANSIT ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)



Increasing residential density along the corridor significantly increases the amount of residents within walking distance to transit stops, thereby increasing the amount of people within 30-minutes of employment by transit. Though a more radical change compared to scenario 1, the gradual redevelopment of low-density residential properties would more substantially support the RAPID line in the long term.

WALKING ACCESS TO EMPLOYMENT
(WITHIN 30 MINUTES)



Walking access to downtown in this scenario also remains relatively similar to the previous scenario, as low-density housing development is mainly centralized in the northern part of the corridor away from downtown.

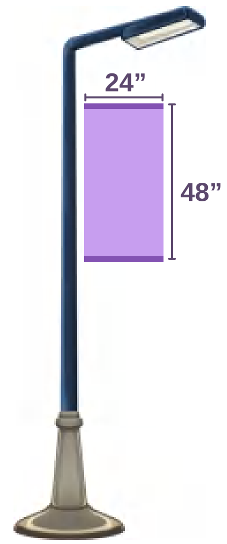
NEIGHBORHOOD CHARACTER ENHANCEMENTS

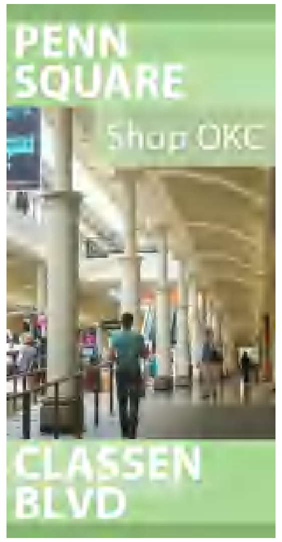
OVERVIEW

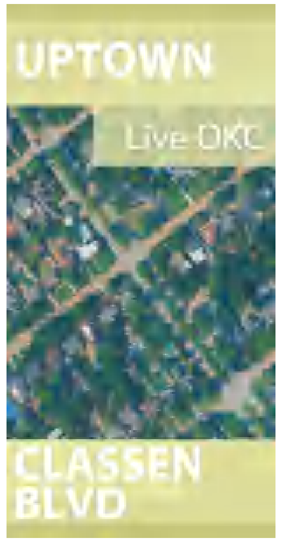
Classen Boulevard connects several neighborhoods, each with its own unique character and history. Our plan seeks to preserve this character as the corridor continues to develop and proposes several elements that can be implemented to enhance the experience of these spaces.

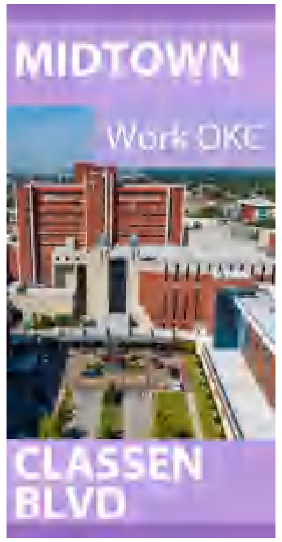
BANNERS

By implementing banners along the length of Classen Boulevard, the individual neighborhoods will feel more distinct, and by using the same visual language, Classen Boulevard will become a more unified thoroughfare.



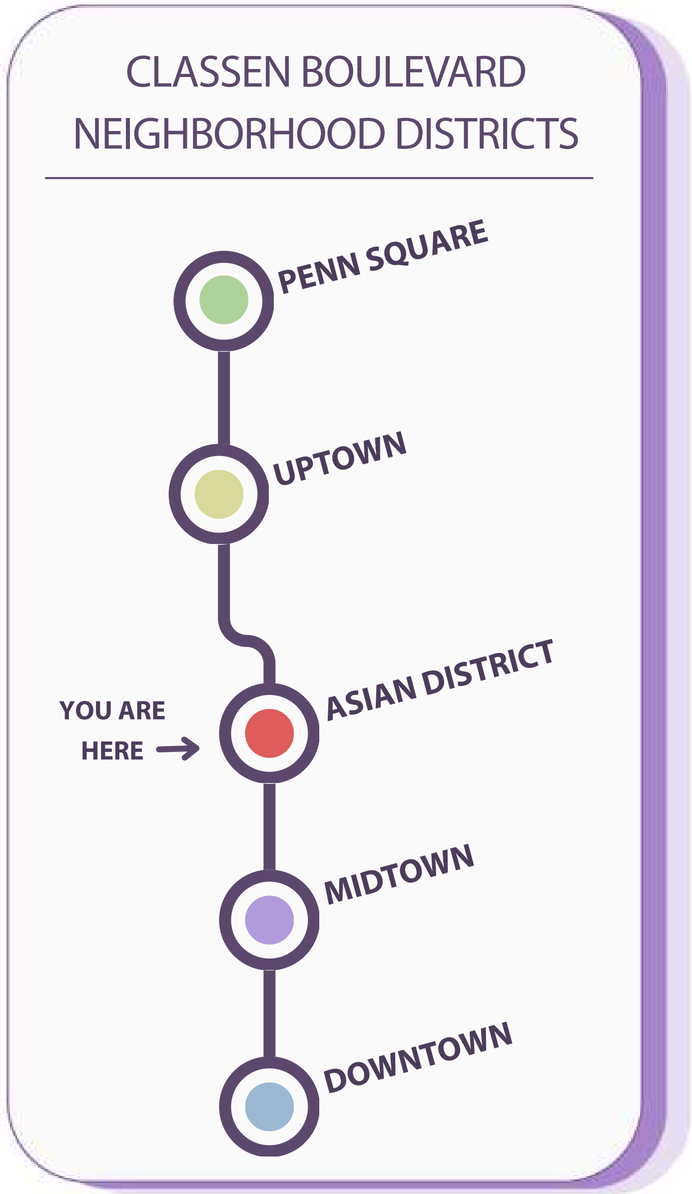






NHBD DIAGRAM

This diagram is meant to be used as a navigational tool to be implemented in bus and transit stations along the route, providing a clear and simple map so users can orient themselves with the greater Classen Boulevard as well as develop associations with each of the highlighted neighborhoods on the route.



CONCLUSION

OVERVIEW

The Classen Corridor Transit Oriented Development Plan provides both a window into the present state of Classen Boulevard as well as a vision for what it could be in the future. This corridor offers an opportunity to create a people-first, transit-rich spine in the heart of the city, serving thousands of Oklahomans every day.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Equitable Growth

The site's demographic mix of 65% renter population and a 40% low-income rate dictates an approach to future development that promotes continued affordability and implements protections against displacement while inviting new investment.

Reliable Infrastructure

By implementing center-running BRT lanes, increasing frequency, and expanding hours, the RAPID line will serve as a reliable mode of mobility for both residents and visitors alike.

Increased density

The future of Classen Boulevard is mixed-use, and through land use scenario modeling, this plan highlights the beneficial impacts that incremental densification can have on the site's access and mobility.

Distinct Identity

By proposing several enhancements to neighborhood character, the plan puts preserving the unique identity of the communities as a high priority.

OUR TEAM

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